Oaks Christian School

High School Student Handbook

Complete collection of the publicly linked handbook pages.

Downloaded October 28, 2026. The online handbook remains the binding version.

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Student Handbook—High School

Original handbook page

Oaks Christian School

General Information

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Facility Use Issues

https://oakschristian.myschoolapp.com/app/#login (AXIS – It all begins here.)

The administration reserves the right to update the policies within this handbook. The online version of the Campus Handbook is the binding version.

Last updated: 8.27.2026

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EMERGENCY CONTACT INFORMATION The following numbers are to be used ONLY in the case of an emergency:

Rob Black – Head of School Office: 818.575.9201 Christi Avren – High School Academic Dean Office: 818.575.9161 Dr. Brad Cook – Head of Athletics Office: 818.575.9134 Dr. Bryndyn Crutcher – Vice Principal Office: 818.575.9255 Emily Davis - Dean of Student Life Office: 818.575.9275 Erick Streelman- Principal Office: 818.575.9236 Garett Freeman – VP/Chief Operating and Risk Officer Office: 818.575.9267 Kevin Lindsey – Senior Academic Dean Office: 818.575.9206 Matt Nelson – Dean of

Student Life Office: 818.575.9262 Dr. Matthew Northrop – Associate Head of School-Academics & Arts Office: 818.575.9212

Welcome from Head of School

Original handbook page

Dear Oaks Christian Parents and Students,

Welcome to the 2026-2027 school year! We are excited to have you at Oaks and count it a significant privilege to be able to partner with you in your educational journey and in our mission of “preparing minds for leadership and hearts for service.”

We have compiled this handbook to provide an expression of our expectations of each other as a learning community. Its content spans from issues of academic concerns to student life to parent involvement. Although the school has prepared this handbook with careful and thoughtful planning, no doubt there will be additional issues and unforeseen concerns as we walk through this school year together. When this happens, we will do our best to communicate with you clearly and quickly, as may be appropriate. In addition to this document, we have made a digital version of the High School Campus Handbook available on AXIS so that parents and students may access it, if needed, at any time.

As this handbook seeks to address most of the general parameters of school life at OCS, it is important that every parent and student read the entire handbook to become familiar with its content and expectations. Students and parents are responsible for understanding the procedures and policy guidelines outlined in this handbook. Completing the enrollment process indicates that the handbook was read, understood, and agreed to for compliance. Information, policies, procedures, and guidelines are an attempt to help the community operate smoothly and fairly, while allowing for discretion, discernment, wisdom and grace within these boundaries, parameters, and guidelines to be considered and enjoyed. The spirit of this handbook is to allow OCS to conduct itself in such a way as to give glory and honor to God, and dignity to each other, in a compassionate and caring way. Our expectation is that our students will use appropriate and proper judgment when given responsibility. It is with that explicit and heartfelt desire that we offer this handbook to the school community.

The student community has a unique opportunity and responsibility to set the standard, and impact the culture, of the school for the future. OCS students will determine school pride and spirit; academic, artistic, and athletic reputation; spiritual development and leadership; and service to the surrounding community. The tradition of Oaks Christian continues with you. May you carry the mantle forward in such a manner that well represents yourself, your family, and your school.

Blessings,

Robert T. Black

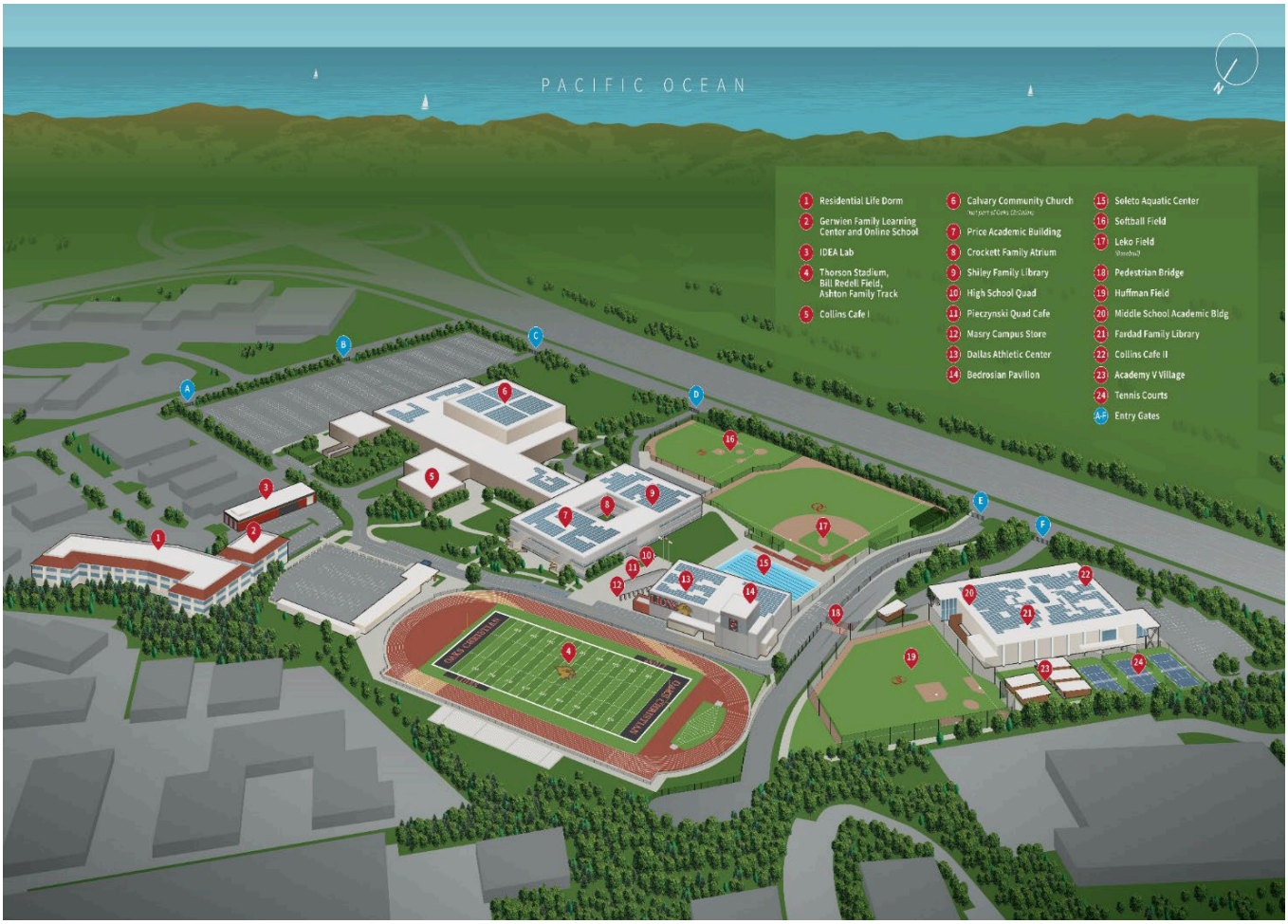
Head of School/President

Campus Maps

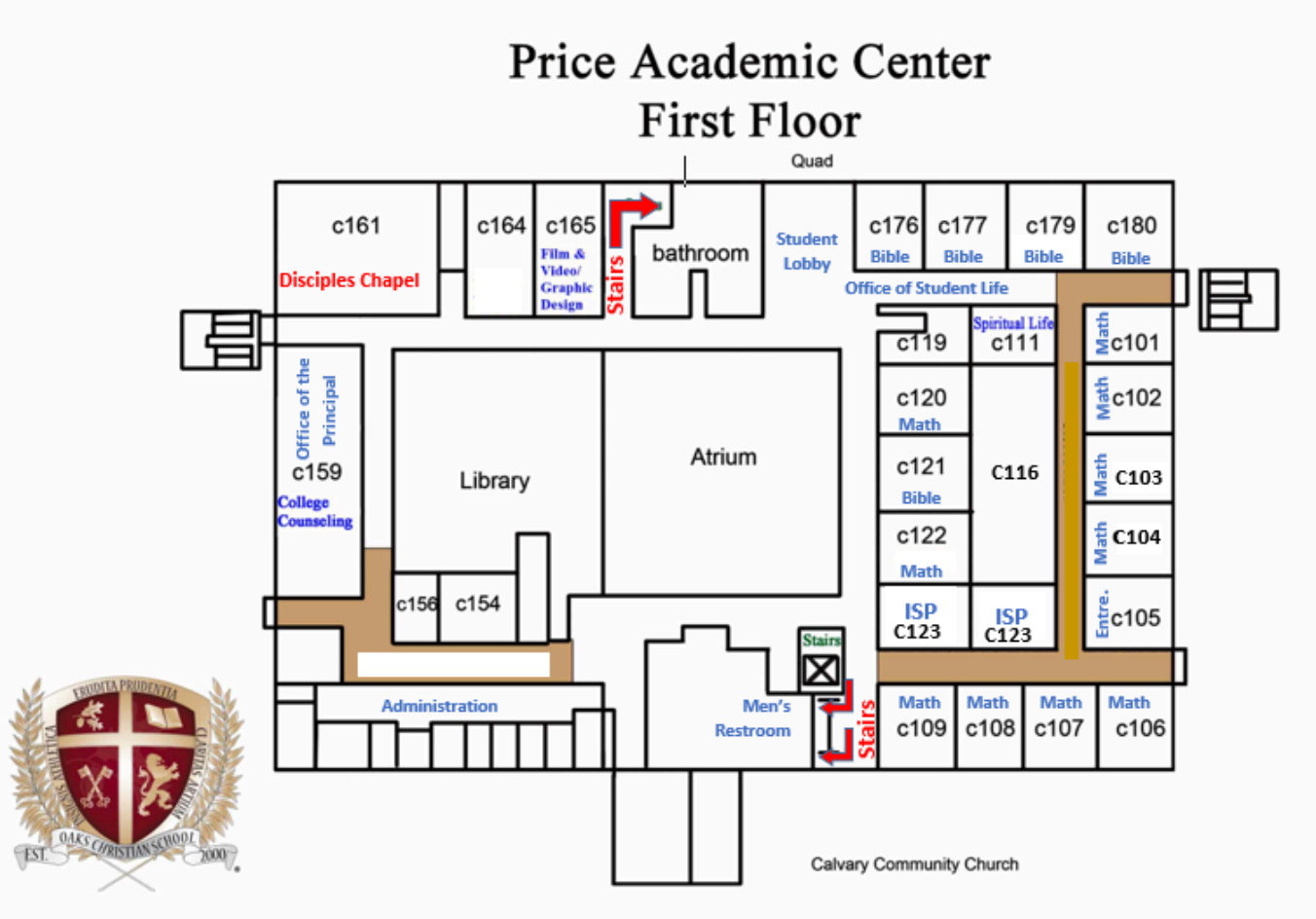
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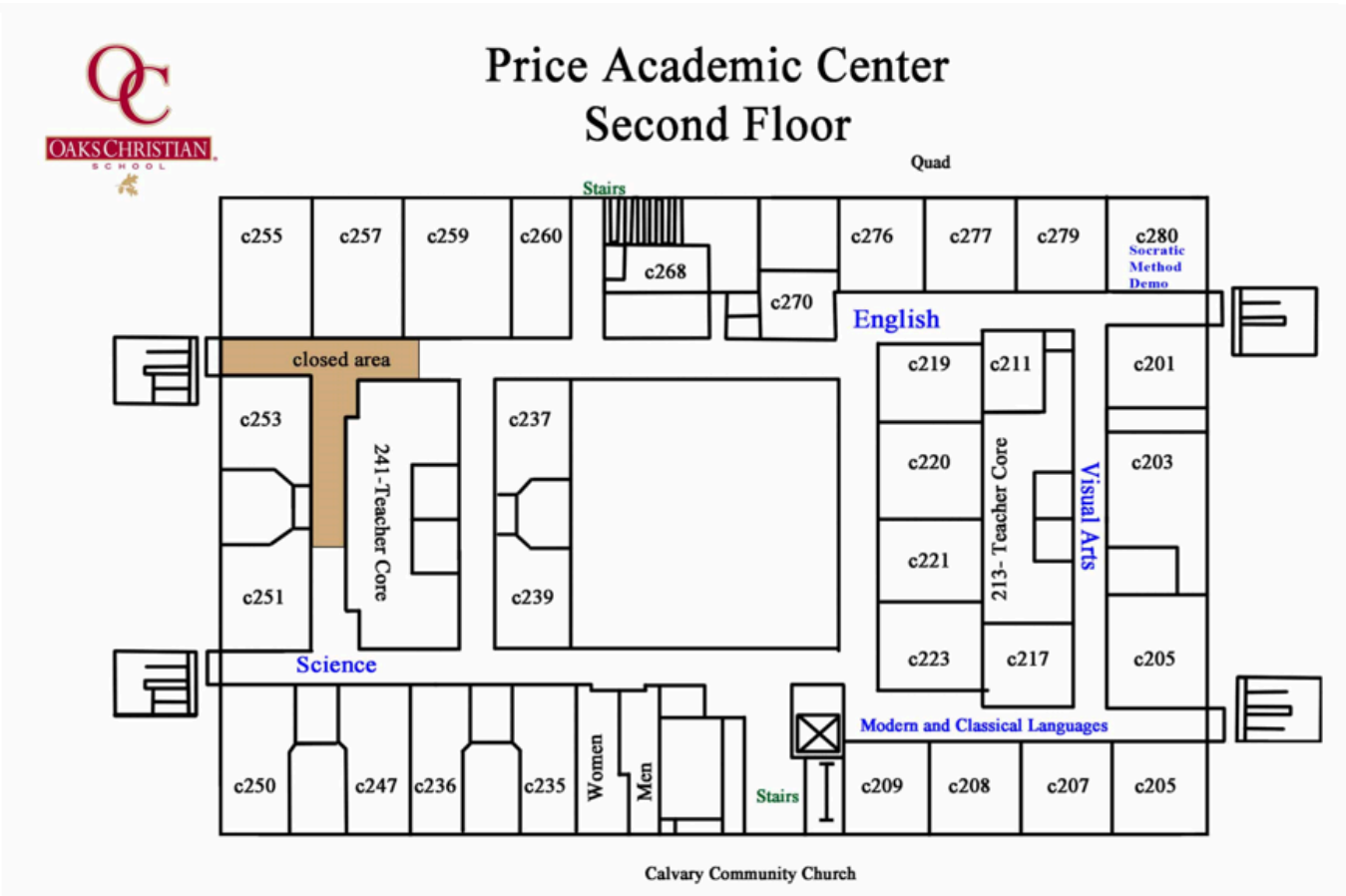
Use the QR Code for Interactive Map
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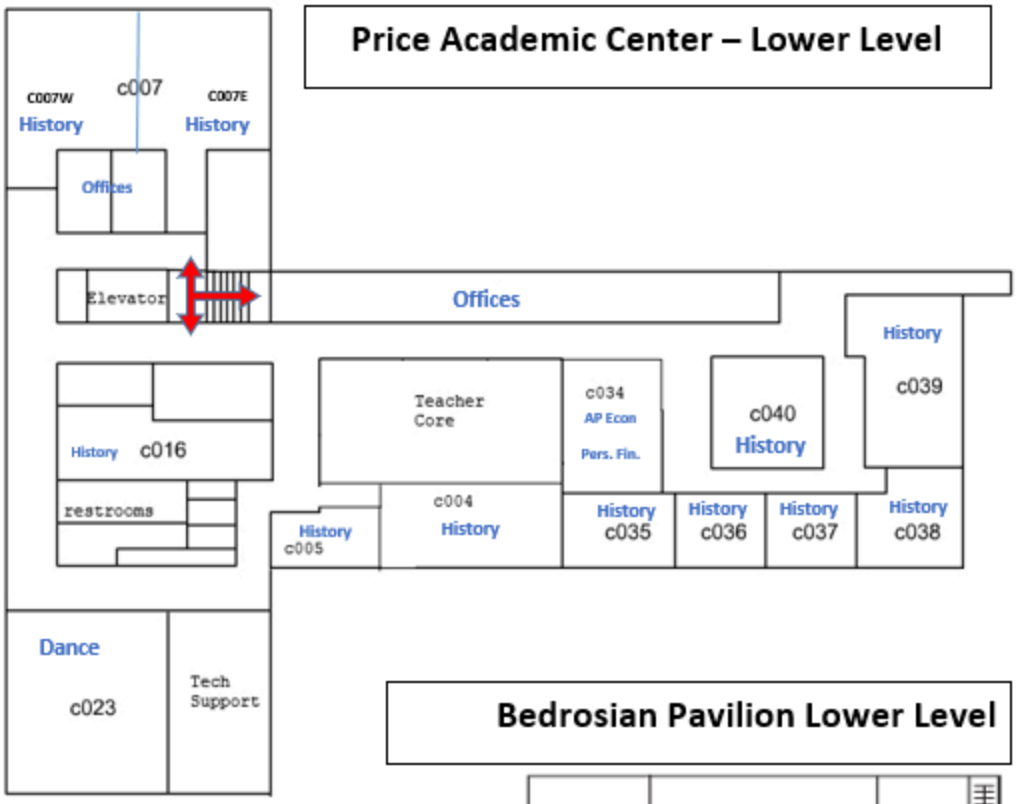

PACIFIC OCEAN
1 Residential Life Dorm
2 Gerwien Family Learning Center and Online School
3 IDEA Lab
4 Thorson Stadium, Bill Redell Field, Ashton Family Track
5 Collins Cafe I
6 Calvary Community Church
7 Price Academic Building
8 Crockett Family Atrium
9 Shiley Family Library
10 High School Quad
11 Pieczynski Quad Cafe
12 Masry Campus Store
13 Dallas Athletic Center
14 Bedrosian Pavilion
15 Soleto Aquatic Center
16 Softball Field
17 Leko Field
18 Pedestrian Bridge
19 Huffman Field
20 Middle School Academic Bldg
21 Fardad Family Library
22 Collins Cafe II
23 Academy V Village
24 Tennis Courts
A-F Entry Gates

Classroom Maps



Price Academic Center
Second Floor




Price Academic Center – Lower Level
C007W
History
c007
C007E
History
Offices
Elevator
Offices
History
c039
Teacher
Core
c034
AP Econ
Pers. Fin.
c040
History
History
c016
restrooms
History
c005
c004
History
History
c035
History
c036
History
c037
History
c038
Dance
c023
Tech
Support


Bedrosian Pavilion Lower Level
Workshop
P009
Dance
P010
Black Box
P004
Control
Room
P017
Media Studio
P004
Men
Women
Choir
P003
P022
P023
Piano
Lab
P024
P027
Band
P002
Teacher's Core
P032
Entrance near Pool

Calendar and Schedule 2026-27

Original handbook page

Full Year Calendar

Oaks Christian School Calendar 2026-2027
Grades 9 - 12

MONTH	DATE	DAY	EVENT
FALL			
August	3-5	Monday-Wednesday	New Employee Orientation
August	6	Thursday	All Employee Retreat
August	7, 10-11	Friday, Monday-Tuesday	All Employee Orientation
August	11	Tuesday	New Parent Orientation, Grades 9 - 12
August	11	Tuesday	Freshman and HS Transfer Student Orientation
August	12	Wednesday	First Day of School, Grades 4 - 12
August	14	Friday	Family Fun Fair
September	7	Monday	Labor Day – No School
September	9	Wednesday	High School Back to School Night
September	21	Monday	In-Service – Pupil Free Day, TK - 12
October	5-8	Monday - Thursday	Middle School Retreats, Freshmen River Trip
October	8	Thursday	Quarter 1 Ends
October	9	Friday	PSAT grades 10, 11. No School for grades 4 – 9, 12
October	12-13	Monday–Tuesday	Fall Break – No School
October	14	Wednesday	In-Service – Pupil Free Day, Grades 9 - 12
October	19-24	Monday-Saturday	Homecoming Week and Dance
November	1	Sunday	Admissions Open House
November	11	Wednesday	Veterans Day (School in Session, TK – 12 Assembly)
November	20	Friday	Grandparents Day, Grades 4 - 12
November	23-27	Monday – Friday	Thanksgiving Break
December	17	Thursday	Last Day of Fall Semester
December	18	Friday	In-Service Day – Pupil Free Day, TK - 12
Dec.-Jan.	12/21-1/1	Monday – Friday	Christmas Break
SPRING			
January	4	Monday	In-Service – Pupil Free Day, TK - 12
January	5	Tuesday	School Resumes, TK - 12
January	14	Thursday	Winter Admission Info Night
January	18	Monday	Martin Luther King Jr. Day – No School
February	12	Friday	In-Service Day – Pupil Free Day, TK - 12
February	15	Monday	Presidents' Day Holiday – No School
February	16-19	Tuesday – Friday	Winter Break
March	11	Thursday	End of Quarter 3
March	12	Friday	In-Service – Pupil Free Day, TK - 12
March	25	Thursday	In-Service – Pupil Free Day, TK - 12
March	22-25	Monday -Wednesday	Senior Retreat (Tentative Date)
March / April	26 - 2	Friday – Friday	Easter Break
May	3	Monday	In-Service

**All dates subject to change*
06.03.2026

First Semester Rotation:

HS Letter Day Rotation Schedule–Fall 2026

X = No School I = In Service/No Students

Blue = Anchor Day Schedule Beige (Late Start) = Assembly / Advisory Yellow = Chapel

Week	Mon	Tues	Wed	Thurs	Fri
Aug 10	I	I	Anchor Convocation	A Chapel	B
Aug 17	Anchor	A Advisory	B	A All – School Chapel	B
Aug 24	Anchor	A Assembly	B	A Chapel	B
Aug 31	Anchor	A Advisory	B	A Chapel	B
Sep 7	X	A Assembly	B	A Chapel	B
Sep 14	Anchor	A Advisory	B	A Chapel	B
Sep 21	In-Service	A Assembly	B	A Chapel	B
Sep 28	Anchor	A Advisory	B	A Chapel	B
Oct 5 River Trip	A Advisory	B	A Chapel	B	PSAT grades 10 and 11
Oct 12	X	X	In-Service	A Chapel	B
Oct 19 HC Week	Anchor	A Assembly	B	A Chapel	B
Oct 26	Anchor	A Advisory	B	A Chapel	B
Nov 2	Anchor	A Assembly	B	A Chapel	B
Nov 9	A Assembly	B	Anchor Veterans Day	A Chapel	B
Nov 16	A Advisory	B	A Chapel	B	Anchor GP Day
Nov 23	X	X	X		

Second Semester Rotation:

Schedule: Daily Meeting Times

SUBJECT TO CHANGE BEFORE SCHOOL BEGINS – CHECK AXIS: Schedules

Please consult the Letter Day Rotation Schedule (letter days Anchor, A and B) for the days of the week each class meets. The most updated schedule will be on AXIS groups: HS Student Life and HS Parents.

Monday (Anchor)	Tuesday (A) Late Start	Wednesday (B)	Thursday (A)	Friday (B)
R1 8:30 – 9:15 AM	R1 9:15 – 10:35 AM	R4 8:30 – 9:50 AM	R1 8:30-9:50 AM	R7 8:30-9:50 AM
R2 9:20-10:05 AM	R2 10:45-12:05 PM	R5 10:00 – 11:20 AM	R3 10:00-11:20 AM	R5 10:00 – 11:20 AM
R3 10:25-11:10 AM	Assembly / Advisory 12:15 - 12:55 PM	Lunch 11:20 – 12:25 PM	Advisory Check in 11:30-11:35 AM Chapel 11:40 – 12:20PM	Lunch 11:20 – 12:25 PM
R4 11:15 AM-12:00 PM				
R5 or Lunch 12:05-12:50 PM	Lunch 12:55 – 1:55PM	R6 12:25 – 1:45 PM	Lunch 12:20 – 1:55PM	R6 12:25 – 1:45 PM
R5 or Lunch 12:50-1:35 PM				
R6 1:40-2:25 PM	R3 1:55-3:15 PM	R7 1:55 -3:15 PM	R2 1:55-3:15 PM	R4 1:55 – 3:15 PM
R7 2:30-3:15 PM				

Mission, Motto, Crest, Goals, Alma Mater, and Portrait of a Graduate

Original handbook page

Mission Statement

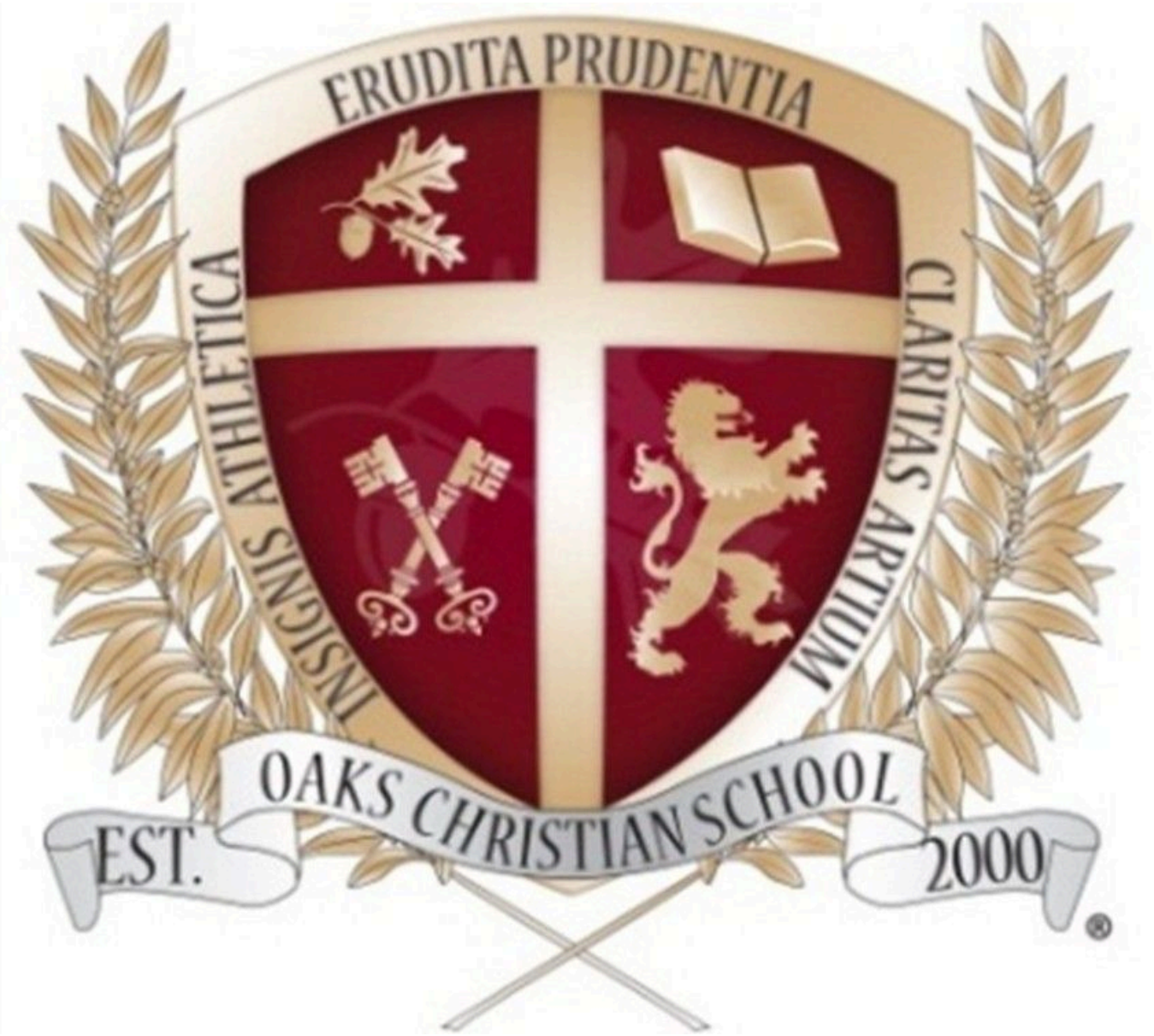
Mission Statement
Motto
Crest
Educational Philosophy and Goals
Alma Mater
Portrait of a Graduate
Copyright Information
Enrollment Agreement

To dedicate ourselves to Christ in the pursuit of academic excellence, artistic expression, and athletic distinction, while growing in knowledge and wisdom through God’s abundant grace.

Motto

Preparing Minds for Leadership and Hearts for Service ®

Crest



About our Crest: The Oaks Christian School crest was designed in 2009 by alum Chris Thompson. The symbols, colors and phrases were chosen to symbolize the values of the OCS mission statement. The crest is a shield, chosen as a reflection of the shield of faith as articulated in Ephesians 6:13-17. Key words from the Oaks Christian School mission statement, translated into Latin, border the shield: Erudita Prudentia (Academic Excellence), Claritas Artium (Artistic Expression), Insignis Athletica (Athletic Distinction).

The deatils of the crest represent the following ideas:

> Cross—represents Christ, Christianity, and Christian service.
>
> Acorn—represents antiquity, strength, and continuous growth.
>
> Bible/Book—represents God's Word and its timeless truths.
>
> Keys—represents unlocking, opening, explaining, and freedom.

> Lion—represents dauntless courage, bravery, strength, and valor.
>
> Olive Branches—represents peace, concordance, and harmony.
>
> Cardinal & Gold—gold represents generosity and elevation of mind; cardinal represents royal majesty, sovereignty, and justice.

Educational Philosophy and Goals

Educational Philosophy

Oaks Christian School exists to provide a Christ-centered education founded on a biblical worldview that honors God and ensures every student can acquire the knowledge and character necessary for progressive growth. This is expressed in the following pursuits:

We aspire to instill in our students a passion to love God and others, demonstrated through virtues such as integrity, discernment, compassion, leadership, and joy. In this, students care for themselves and each other.

We value the uniqueness of each student and seek to both know them and support their progress as scholars, artists, and athletes in its varied and individual expression.

We create a diverse, challenging learning environment that draws students away from self-centered thinking to active contribution. When students encounter struggle, rather than shy away, they learn to persist in problem-solving by drawing on the curiosity, character, and understanding cultivated through their studies. They engage in ideas that prepare them to meet the challenges of their world and make a positive difference.

We desire a community of servant-leaders who through wisdom and love desire to bring good to the world.

School Goals

The Oaks Christian Community will

> foster an understanding of the sovereignty of God, which provides a framework for the application of knowledge;
>
> provide a comprehensive and college preparatory education through diverse learning experiences within an engaging community;
>
> provide a challenging learning environment that fosters critical thinking, personal responsibility, and persistent effort;
>
> refine our bodies and character through teamwork and in competition that honors God;
>
> develop an understanding and appreciation of the arts, and encourage good stewardship of our artistic abilities;
>
> encourage a passion to love God and others through living lives that reflect the virtues taught and modeled by Christ including justice, wisdom, courage, service, reconciliation, grace, and humility.

Alma Mater

Words by Jim Altizer

Music composed by Mary Kay Altizer

Music arranged by David T. Clydesdale

Comprehending God’s creation

Understanding His Holy Word

All compelling, all pursuing

Minds to lead and hearts to serve

Like the oak tree, we grow stronger

Like the lion we will lead

Like the Savior, we lay down our lives

Serving with integrity

To refine through perseverance

To create that which is good

To reflect His grace and mercy

To embrace all that is true

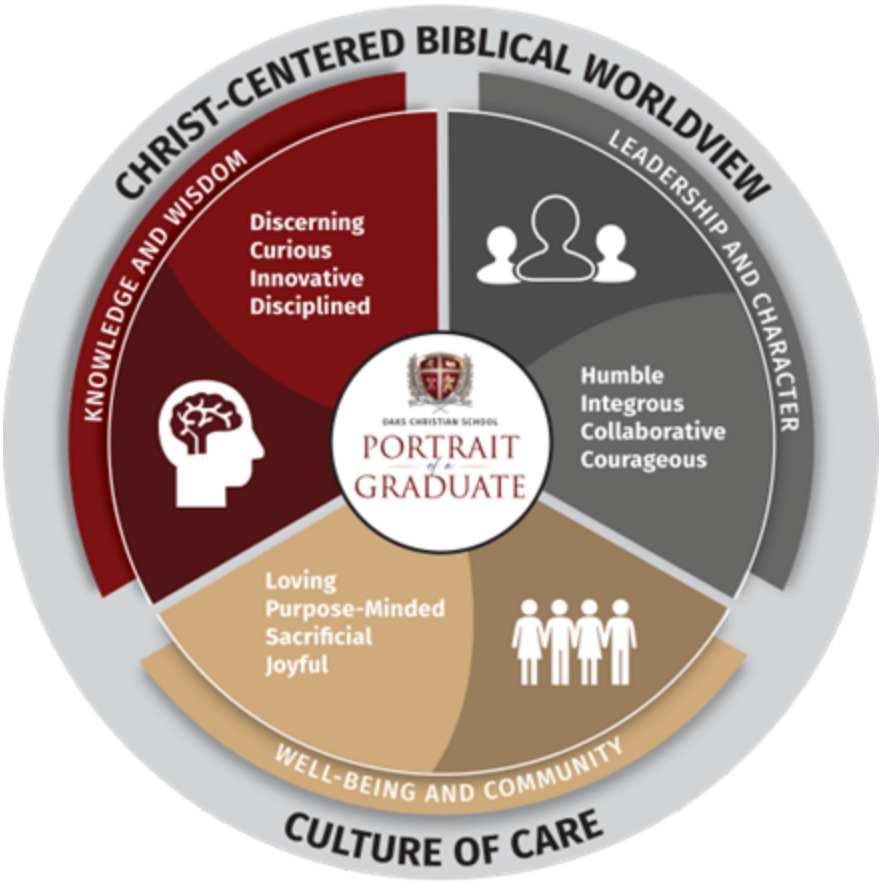
We stand firm, Oaks Christian School

We stand firm, Oaks Christian School

We stand firm, Oaks Christian School

Portrait of a Graduate

Portrait of a Graduate is our ultimate hope for all our students. We consciously educate toward this end: to graduate purpose-minded students who are caring and compassionate servant-leaders that use their knowledge, gifts, and abilities to be positive influences in the world. This aspirational model rests on a biblical worldview nurtured in a culture of care. We begin focusing on these character traits the moment students walk into our classrooms until the time they cross the stage to graduate.



Copyright Information

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Enrollment Agreement

Upon enrollment, all students and parents have agreed to abide by all policies in the campus handbook as implemented by the administration, faculty, and staff of Oaks Christian School.

Social Media

Original handbook page

Oaks Christian School and Social Media
OCS Social Media Policy—Students and Parents

Oaks Christian School and Social Media

Today's world offers constant and dynamic communication. Navigating it responsibly and productively is our goal at Oaks Christian School.

As a school, we value the emergence of social media as a communication tool and one which affords us the opportunity to communicate on a daily and interactive basis through our official Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram platforms. While we value social media, we caution our parents and students to understand the benefits and dangers of its use.

On the pages that follow, please find the OCS Social Media Policy and associated protocols, which have been established for the protection of Oaks Christian School, employees, students, and parents from private and unprofessional uses of social media, as well as to maintain consistent communication opportunities for OCS students who may not be allowed access to social media platforms. Please keep in mind that it is not the school's desire to limit effective and necessary communications, but to put reasonable, responsible, and professional protocols in place for the protection of the OCS community and to uphold Oaks Christian School's quality standards.

OCS Social Media Policy—Students and Parents

Vision and Mission: At Oaks Christian School, our vision is to allow the official OCS social media platforms to be an extension of our school website and AXIS (Learning Management System) providing a dynamic venue for students, parents, and friends to receive up-to-date event information and news about OCS students and the OCS community at large, while advancing our school mission for "academic excellence, artistic expression, athletic distinction." For example, our official Oaks Christian School Facebook provides a day-to-day view into OCS student life as we post photos and news about student academic, artistic, athletic, spiritual life, and community service accomplishments. Our official sites are carefully managed by designated OCS employees, ensuring consistency in professionalism, integrity, privacy standards, and accuracy of the information.

Unauthorized Sites: Unfortunately, there have been unsanctioned social media sites that have used the Oaks Christian School name, word marks, and logos, while violating trademark laws and misrepresenting our school. These unauthorized sites have the potential to promote cyberbullying, harassment, and other unsafe or unlawful practices, and every effort is made to close these sites. Please visit only the authorized, official OCS Facebook, Twitter and Instagram sites when connecting to Oaks Christian School via social media.

Official OCS Social Media Sites: Official OCS social media sites are managed under the oversight of the marketing department. The school's official OCS social media accounts are listed below. To maintain and

preserve brand quality as well as content and privacy standards, Oaks Christian School desires to limit these accounts and does not anticipate authorizing any additional accounts at this time.

- Oaks Christian School Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, and LinkedIn
  - General OCS information and events
  - Contact: Victoria Griffith, Visual & Performing Arts Marketing/Website Specialist.

vgriffith@oakschristian.org

- Oaks Christian Institute of Arts and Innovation (OCSIAI) Instagram

News specific to the Institute of Arts and Innovation students, program, faculty, and staff

Contact: Lauren Hemsworth, Performing Arts Creative Content Specialist, lhemsworth@oakschristian.org

- Oaks Christian Visual and Performing Arts Instagram (Oakschristianarts)
  - News Specific to the OCS visual and performing arts departments, faculty, staff, and students
  - Contact Lauren Hemsworth, Performing Arts Creative Content Specialist lhemsworth@oakschristian.org
- Oaks Christian Lions (athletics) Instagram (oakschristianlions) and Twitter (@OaksChrstnLions)
  - Contact David Lopez, Athletic Marketing Specialist,

dlopez@oakschristian.org

- Oaks Christian International Boarding Program Facebook
  - Specific to news and events for our international students, parents, and host families
  - Contact: Nicole Oakes, Director of International Student Programs,

noakes@oakschristian.org

- Oaks Christian Alumni Association Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram
  - Specific to our OCS alumni, providing alumni news and information about upcoming alumni events and reunions
  - Contact: Jean Schintee, Alumni Activities Coordinator.

jschintee@oakschristian.org

News, information, and photos from specific departments, classes, clubs, etc. can be sent to the account managers listed above. Additionally, news and information can also be sent to Maria Cowell, Director of Marketing and Communications.

No OCS employee, department, student, or parent should create or maintain an unsanctioned social media site using the Oaks Christian School name, word marks, logos, or images. Representing Oaks Christian School via any unauthorized social media platform is unlawful and a violation of school policy and conduct protocols. All unauthorized social media accounts that have been created to represent the school, its programs, or its employees, students, or parents should be closed immediately.

Participation in social media, including official OCS social media sites as well as non-official pages (i.e., personal Facebook, third-party sites), shall be undertaken in the best interest of Oaks Christian School, its employees, students, and parents, as determined in the sole and absolute discretion of OCS. Oaks Christian

School prohibits the posting of confidential or proprietary information related to OCS employees, students, and parents, and prohibits the expression of opinions that could be considered opinions of the school without the prior written authorization of the OCS head of school, principals, or deans. Engagement in any social media sites must not violate any local, state, federal, or international laws and regulations, nor should it be disruptive, threatening, profane, abusive, harassing, embarrassing, torturous, defamatory, obscene, libelous, or bullying.

Monitor and Educate: Parents should be especially mindful of the uses and abuses of social media and the potential harm to their children. At Oaks Christian School, we take seriously our responsibility when communicating with the OCS community—both students and parents. While we can discipline students who use the school's name, word marks, and logos without permission or violate our school community conduct code of honesty, respect for others, personal integrity, and Christian character, we cannot protect students from all abuses except as parents monitor their student’s social media activities. All of us need to be aware that social media is not private; it is a doorway to allowing many “friends” and organizations to have access to a great deal of personal information. Each parent needs to make informed decisions on behalf of their children and keep aware of the constantly changing climate of social media.

(The OCS Social Media Policy may be amended or revised as needed.)

Biblical Worldview

Original handbook page

Statement of Faith

All people in all places hold presuppositions around which they order their very existence. A worldview is a perspective, a set of precepts that guides our behavior, a way of thinking and doing. A Biblical worldview is one built on the premise that all truth is God's truth. Thus, if God is the Sovereign Creator, then all areas of inquiry are beneficial for our edification. This translates into a desire to know, a thirst to understand humanity and the world. The facts upon which Christianity rest, as found in the scriptures and Christian doctrines, inform and make up the framework of the Biblical worldview.

At Oaks Christian School, denominational differences are to be understood, while the essentials of the faith are to be celebrated. We look at all of learning and life through the following truths of scripture:

Creation (humanity made in God's image; creation is good; innate desire to know God's sovereignty)

The Fall (sin and its effects; death; humanity's constant struggle with God)

Redemption (of humanity back to God; the incarnation of God in Christ; salvation)

Future Hope (eternity; the temporal versus eternal world; the Second Coming of Christ)

We recognize the common grace (revelation of the truths of God to Christians and non-Christians alike) manifested throughout all the created order.

Statement of Faith

> We believe the Bible to be the inspired and only infallible Word of God.

> We believe that there is only one God, eternally existent in three persons: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

> We believe that mankind was created good, but lost the hope of life eternal, destroyed his communion with God, and fell under the bondage of sin and death by rebelling against God's perfect way of life.

> We believe that Jesus Christ is God's eternal Son, who redeemed mankind. As true God and true man, He was born of a virgin through the Holy Spirit, taught men how to live through His sinless life, took the consequences of our sin upon Himself in His passion and death upon the cross, arose bodily from the dead on the third day after His death, was seen by His disciples, ascended to the right hand of the Father and will return in power and glory.

> We believe that all are sinners, that all are called to repentance and faith in Jesus Christ, that no one can come to the Father except through Jesus Christ, and that no one can come to faith in Christ, repent and attain holiness, but by the grace of God.

> We believe as a gift from God, sexual intimacy is to be experienced only between a man and a woman within a marital relationship. We believe, therefore, that any other form of sexual intimacy is not in keeping with God's plan for mankind.

> We believe that the Holy Spirit is freely given to those that believe in Jesus Christ, that the fruits and benefits of Christ's redemption are applied to us individually by the Holy Spirit, and that the Holy Spirit

> lives in us and enables us to live godly lives.

> We believe that at the end of the age there will be two resurrections: one to eternal life and glory, the other to eternal condemnation.

Graduation Requirements and General Policies

Original handbook page

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS
ACADEMIC LIFE

Students at Oaks Christian School are developing the ability to think critically and deeply; preparing for college; becoming independent and articulate learners; forming within themselves the knowledge and responsibility for leadership; seeking to develop their faith; and developing a sense of a Christian worldview. Essential to this are supportive teachers—dedicated Christians who are excellent both in teaching and in knowledge. Teachers do not separate intellectual life from the spiritual. In the academic environment at Oaks Christian School, students will be challenged to think independently, open-mindedly, critically, and creatively. But it is also integral to our mission that students will be challenged to know God. All disciplines emphasize critical thinking, formulation and defense of ideas, and the presentation of facts. To this end, effective writing is stressed in instruction across disciplines, and it is not uncommon for a course to be taught in a seminar format. The Oaks Christian School course of study requires students to read extensively and to be highly motivated.

ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS

Requirements for Promotion and Diploma—The following pertain to the granting of promotion and diplomas:

> To be promoted and eligible for a diploma, a student must earn credit in all graduation requirements outlined below.

> A failing grade in a course that is not required for graduation will be recorded but will not jeopardize eligibility for a diploma.

> Seniors who have failed one or more of the required academic classes, or another requirement such as PE, will be required to repeat the failed work in an accredited summer school before receiving a diploma or a transcript showing the graduation date.

Diploma Requirements—The curriculum of Oaks Christian School is college-preparatory. It comprises a required core of studies believed to be fundamental to a liberal arts education as well as elective courses designed to fit the needs and interests of the individual student. The course of study follows a traditional college-preparatory path, which includes advanced offerings. For a four-year program at Oaks Christian School, a minimum of 21 academic credits is required for graduation: Bible (2.5 years); history (3.5 years); English (4 years); mathematics (3 years—must successfully complete Algebra II); science (3 years—must complete biology and either chemistry or physics); foreign language (must complete either Level III or two years of two separate languages); fine arts (2 years—one credit must include a continuous, year-long class). Other requirements include two credits in PE (see below for details), one half-credit semester elective, one-

year elective credit in Health, and community service. All graduation requirements must be taken through Oaks Christian School.

Physical Education—Each student is required to take any combination of two semesters of PE or seasons of participation on an OCS athletic team. Although we encourage students to try out for athletic teams, we cannot guarantee each student a place on the team. If a student is cut from a team or chooses not to participate, s/he can enroll in an independent physical education course through Oaks Christian Online School.

Summer School—Many students attend summer school for enrichment, remediation, or advancement. Except when making up a D or F in a class required for graduation, Oaks Christian School does not give course credit for summer study taken outside of Oaks Christian School, although placement credit may be given. For continuity, Oaks Christian School recommends remediation or advancement courses be taken through our summer school whenever possible. Summer school grades from outside of Oaks Christian School appear on the OCS transcript but are not calculated in the student's Oaks Christian School GPA although it can positively affect college admissions, CIF, and graduation eligibility. Oaks Christian School summer school grades replace the original grade for the purpose of GPA calculation, but the original grade will remain, along with the new grade, on the transcript. Students who wish to improve a grade of C- or lower may do so at a community college or other accredited institution, or they may retake the course during the regular school year. The original course taken at Oaks Christian School, however, remains in the student's GPA. Students taking summer school courses to advance to a higher level in any discipline must discuss the plan with the appropriate department chair during the spring semester prior to summer school enrollment. The department chair may arrange an Oaks Christian School examination at the end of the summer. If work on the examination shows that the student is prepared for the next level, his/her schedule will be changed accordingly.

GPA—A weighted GPA is used to determine NHS (National Honor Society) eligibility, valedictorian, "Top Ten" honors, and limited other recognitions.

Valedictorian- The student with the highest weighted GPA (based on 7 semesters) in the graduating class is eligible to be valedictorian. However, the awarding of this distinction is subject to approval from the Director of College Counseling, Senior Academic Dean, High School Principal, and ultimately, the Head of School. Students with academic concerns not directly reflected in a GPA may still be ruled ineligible to earn the distinction of valedictorian. Examples of concerns are listed below. This is not an all-inclusive list.

> Academic Integrity violations or concerns
>
> Behavior concerns in and out of the classroom
>
> Disingenuous college admissions processes

Additionally, the distinction of valedictorian does not ensure a speaking role at graduation. The student speakers at graduation are based on student nominations and administrative approval.

ACADEMIC LIFE

Daily Schedule—Classes rotate through a modified block schedule. Students meet with all their classes on Anchor Days (typically Mondays) and then rotate through their classes on alternating A Days (typically

Tuesdays/Thursdays) and B Days (typically Wednesdays/Fridays). Schedules are updated and accurate in AXIS and should be checked regularly.

Class Load—Freshmen and Sophomores are expected to take seven classes. Juniors are expected to take a minimum of six classes. Seniors are expected to take a minimum of five classes. This total includes classes taken on campus and through OCO.

Open Periods—Some students may not be scheduled for a formal class during one of the class rotations. Because of the academic expectations of the school, students are expected to use their time appropriately. Open periods are for on-campus tutoring, meeting teachers, participating in study groups, or other responsible uses. A student's priority is always to make up for any deficiency in a class.

Textbooks—Oaks Christian provides book purchasing services through AXIS in our online bookstore. The Oaks Christian Bookstore provides purchasing choices for all required texts, both digital and print. Please purchase all required texts well in advance to avoid backorders or expedited shipping fees. These texts must be purchased in advance as students will use the first days of school. Teachers will provide other resources in class or if necessary, additional purchasing information for supplies.

Homework—Successful instruction depends on the preparation of each student. Students are expected to enter class prepared with the previously assigned work. The amount will vary from assignment to assignment and some upper-level honors/AP courses may require more time.

Late Work—Meeting deadlines by turning assigned work in on time provides check points for growth and builds foundations for future learning. Whether late work can be turned in after a unit has passed is subject to department policy (found in course syllabus). However, work from the previous quarter cannot be turned in during the new quarter. Any exception must be approved by the high school principal.

Make-up Work—Students are expected to complete assignments on time and to take tests and quizzes when assigned. Students must make up work immediately upon missing school, no later than the day after returning to school, unless the absence is prolonged and/or arrangements have been made with the teacher.

Students who miss class because of any school function (e.g., athletics, trips, and school business) must make up the work no later than the next school day. The school does not ask teachers to accept late work. If such work is accepted, it will be assessed with a penalty per dept policy.

A student who misses a single class period or part of the day is required to make up any quizzes/tests and turn in any assignments due on the same day of the partial absence.

A student who misses class the day before a test or the day of the test is expected to take the test immediately upon returning to school.

Students who are called out for an appointment and do not pre-arrange a time to make up the assessment with the teacher will be assessed a grade penalty.

Concussion Protocol

If a student suffers a head injury or is suspected of suffering from a concussion, the nurse or trainer will require the student to be evaluated by a licensed health professional who is qualified to diagnose concussions.

It is the responsibility of the student to report to the school if he/she has been diagnosed with a concussion, whether the concussion occurred at school or off campus.

If a student is diagnosed with a concussion, then academic accommodation may be provided pending documentation from the licensed health professional. The preferred form of documentation is through an ACE form.

The school nurse will receive all medical documentation and then contact the Academic Dean who will communicate with the teachers of the student. Students who are on academic accommodations may not “Return to Play” in any extracurricular activity (sports, dance, and performances) until a clearance has been submitted with both “Return to Play” and “Return to Learn.” In other words, a student is not allowed to be playing an Oaks sport/performing at Oaks if the student is still on academic accommodations.

Students who are suffering from a concussion for an extended period may be required to have periodic follow ups with their health professional accompanied by follow up documentation. In rare cases, students out for a prolonged period may need to take an incomplete in the course and complete the course(s) by an agreed upon time period.

Final Exams—Two-hour examinations are given at the end of each semester and are required for most courses. The grade received is incorporated into the semester grade and can be no more than 20% of that grade.

Rescheduling Final Exams—Students who cannot take their final exam at the given time must submit a request to reschedule a final examination at least two weeks in advance to the Office of Academics. Upon review, the Dean will determine if the final can be rescheduled and if any grade deduction will be taken from the final score. Parents are required to schedule their vacations around exam schedules. Please contact the Office of Academics with questions, 818.575.9236.

Honors/Advanced Placement Programs—The Honors and AP programs offer enrichment in which learning is done at greater depth and at a faster pace. The student in such a class is an accomplished reader and a skilled, analytical thinker. Each honors and AP course has specific prerequisites and necessary approvals to enroll or stay in the program. Students may only take three such courses unless petition for four is granted by the Academic Office. Faculty may recommend that a student be dropped if it becomes clear early in the year that the placement is inappropriate. Any student earning a grade lower than C- at the semester may be moved to the CP level of the same course wherever possible. Any student with excessive absences for any reason may be moved to the CP level of the same course upon teacher recommendation. A student who transfers from an honors class to the regular class will not receive a “grade bump.” Students enrolled in AP classes must take the AP examinations. Students who take an AP course and subsequently choose not to take the AP exam will have the AP designation removed from the course. Students not enrolled in AP classes are permitted to take the AP examinations upon approval of the AP instructor.

Grades and Grading Policy

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GRADES AND GRADING POLICY
LETTER GRADES
ATTENDANCE and ENGAGEMENT
CITIZENSHIP GRADES
Remediation Policy

GRADES AND GRADING POLICY

Grading Periods—The grading period operates on a semester calendar. The fall semester runs from August to December, and the spring semester runs from January to late May/early June.

Grading Reports—Semester grades are the official grades recorded on a student's transcript. The school also issues quarter grades that, while unofficial, provide an assessment of progress at the midpoint of each semester. For students earning a grade below C- at the end of any grading period, teachers include written comments with suggestions for improvement. Comments are not part of an official transcript. All grade reports, including mid-semester progress reports, are posted on AXIS for parents and students. Only those grades earned at the conclusion of each semester are recorded on a student's transcript.

Grade Calculation—The school will provide two different GPA calculations: an overall unweighted GPA using a traditional four-point grading scale and a weighted academic GPA, which will grant an extra grade point in honors and AP courses (not be awarded to any grade below C- in honors and AP courses). The weighted academic GPA will include courses in history, English, mathematics, science, foreign language, Bible, and any AP course not in these disciplines. A weighted GPA is used to determine National Honor Society (NHS) eligibility, valedictorian, honor roll, and limited other recognitions. An unweighted GPA includes all Oaks Christian School classes.

Grade Points Average (GPA)—Grades are computed using the following:

Letter	Grade %	GPA	Honors GPA
A	93-100	4.0	5.0
A-	90-92	3.7	4.7
B+	87-89	3.3	4.3
B	83-86	3.0	4.0
B -	80-82	2.7	3.7
C+	77-79	2.3	3.3
C	73-76	2.0	3.0
C-	70-72	1.7	2.7

D+	67-69	1.3	1.3
D	63-66	1.0	1.0
D-	60-62	0.7	0.7
F	59 & below	0.0	0.0

LETTER GRADES

Grades assigned to a student's work indicate progress, proficiency, and achievement. The following is a definition of each grade as a description of a student's performance in a course:

> A—The student's preparation and work is superior in its power, thoroughness, and precision. It shows a facility that allows students to think beyond what has been presented, applying ideas in new contexts.

> B—The student's work is effective and demonstrates success in comprehension, application, and analysis. The student's work shows a competent understanding of much of the material of the course.

> C—The student demonstrates competence in some, but not all, aspects of the course.

> D—The student acquired most aspects of the course material but has not demonstrated effective and complete understanding or application. Passing graduation credit is given.

> F—The student has not progressed in understanding course material and/or meeting course objectives and will not receive graduation credit for the course.

There is a significant difference between a passing grade (D- and above) and a college-recommending grade. A college may rescind an offer of placement to a student whose grade in any subject falls to a C or below. Also, the University of California and Cal State Universities do not recognize an English course in which the student received a D. The best means to not only earn a passing grade but also benefit from learning is to attend class regularly and seek extra.

Incomplete—Students are expected to complete all work each semester. If at the end of the semester a student has not completed work because of an unforeseen emergency or significant illness, the student can petition the Academic Dean for an Incomplete instead of a letter grade. An Incomplete will stand for a designated number of calendar days determined by the dean and teacher.

Academic Probation—Any student who earns one or more F's or two or more D+'s (or lower) grades in academic subjects on any quarter or semester report card, will be placed on academic probation. Such a student has one quarter to improve. Any student on academic probation for two quarters in a school year may be subject to dismissal from Oaks Christian School. A student on academic probation may be required to attend tutoring at the Learning Center.

Students on Academic Probation will be scheduled to attend drop-in tutoring for additional academic support. Students who do not attend scheduled tutoring sessions:

> will NOT be allowed to participate in Oaks Christian extracurricular opportunities (e.g., athletics, arts, activities, etc.).

> where applicable, will lose off-campus privileges.

Transferring and Dropping Courses—To transfer or drop a course, a student must first obtain a Drop/Add Form from the Office of Academics and then return it completed and signed. No change will be considered until an academic counselor has agreed. Oaks Christian School does not make changes to a schedule based on teacher request. Transfers into semester-only courses must take place during the first two cycles of the term. Courses dropped after two cycles will be recorded on the transcript as withdrawn (W/D) with no grade given. If a course is dropped one week after mid-semester (quarter) grades are reported, the grade will be listed as W/F (Withdraw/Fail). If a student drops from an AP course to a CP course after two weeks, the current grades (unweighted) will be transferred to the transferred course.

Transcripts—A student's transcript shows the grades earned for each semester. Transcripts may also show grades for work taken in summer schools or in schools other than Oaks Christian School during the school year. Students who wish work accomplished elsewhere to be on the OCS transcript should bring a record of that work to the registrar. The transcript grade point average is calculated on OCS grades only. Courses taken at other schools will not be reflected in the OCS GPA. Oaks Christian retains the right to withhold transcripts until all fees and costs due to Oaks Christian are paid in full.

Class Rank—Oaks Christian School does not rank its students.

Honor Roll—The Honor Roll is a distinction granted at the end of each semester to those students who have achieved an unweighted 3.0 GPA in that semester and who fulfill the following requirements: have no grades lower than B- in any class; have demonstrated appropriate citizenship; have faithfully and consistently carried out their school responsibilities; and have earned citizenship grades of Satisfactory or above during that grading period. The following are distinctions within OCS's Honor Roll (high school):

> Head of School's List: GPA of at least 3.75
>
> Dean's List: GPA of at least 3.5
>
> Honor Roll: GPA of at least 3.0

To be on Honor Roll, students must earn citizenship grades of Satisfactory or above during that grading period. Students who receive an "N" for citizenship will meet with their teacher(s) and administrator(s) to discuss specific ways to cultivate character growth until the next grading period.

The Head of School's List, Dean's List and Honor Roll recipients are honored at the end of each semester and are based on unweighted GPA.

> For specifics, please refer to the individual course syllabus.

ATTENDANCE and ENGAGEMENT

All teachers incorporate an engagement category into their gradebook that is determined by active class engagement.

Engagement is dependent on student attendance. With the exception of school-approved absences only, any student absent from class will be ineligible to earn engagement points for that class period. At the end of the grading term (semester) a student's lowest two weeks of this grading category will be excluded from the final calculation. This is to account for sickness, family emergencies, etc. Any exception to this rule must be made by administration.

Specific criteria for earning engagement credit will be determined by class/department and published in each teacher's COE.

CITIZENSHIP GRADES

What we learn and how we live because of it are inextricably connected. Citizenship grades mark progress in the development of characteristics that Oaks Christian deems reflective of the educational opportunity we provide.

Criteria for Citizenship Grades

The following six characteristics, taken from the Portrait of a Graduate, comprise the kind of positive contribution that marks outstanding citizenship.

- Discipline
  - Attends class consistently and on time
  - Brings required materials to class
  - Completes reading and homework on time
  - Prepares for class
- Collaboration
  - Contributes readily
  - Participates constructively in discussion
  - Works effectively in team tasks
- Curiosity
  - Asks questions
  - Makes connections
  - Communicates active engagement
- Humility
  - Welcomes critique
  - Respects others
  - Listens patiently
- Joy
  - Maintains positive attitude
  - Values growth
- Communication
  - Proactively communicates planned absences
  - Takes responsibility for making up missing work

(O) Outstanding: Citizenship consistently reflects all six of these characteristics.

(G) Good: Citizenship consistently reflects five of these characteristics.

(S) Satisfactory: Citizenship consistently reflects three-four of these characteristics.

(N) Needs Improvement: When students do not regularly come to class prepared and on time, it inevitably diminishes their ability to contribute well because it fosters a disconnect between the activity of and responsibility for learning. When students' habits do not reflect a desire to grow into the characteristics of good citizenship, they hurt not only their own progress but also the progress of their classmates. This comes through in actions such as these:

> Focusing only on themselves
>
> Being unprepared for class
>
> Having an incurious, apathetic attitude
>
> Offering minimal participation
>
> Derailing learning through irrelevant or inappropriate comments
>
> Rejecting critique
>
> Refusing help

Remediation Policy

Grades 9 and 10

An 'F' earned in any graduation requirement must be remediated through Oaks Christian School or Oaks Christian Online School. This can take place during the summer or the subsequent school year. Whether or not Summer School is an option is at the discretion of the Academic Dean.

> If a student earns an 'F' during the first semester in any graduation requirement, the student will be required to sign up for the same class the subsequent school year. If they earn a C- or better, during the second semester, they will be allowed to progress to the next level. Remediation for the first-semester grade still must take place through Oaks Christian School or Oaks Christian Online School.
>
> If a student earns an F in both semesters, they must take the same course the subsequent school year.
>
> If a student earns 3 consecutive F's (3 semesters) in the same 'Core' graduation-required course, they are subject to being counseled out of Oaks Christian School.
>
> By the beginning of Grade 11, all earned F's must be remediated. Any student with F's in graduation requirements will not be allowed to begin Grade 11 without the approval of the Senior Academic Dean.

Note: The above guidelines refer to grades at the end of a term (semester). Quarter grades are reports on progress during which learning supports may be mandated in order to help students remedy their progress.

Grades 11 and 12

An 'F' earned during Grades 11 or 12 may be remediated outside of Oaks Christian School. However, no student is eligible for an Oaks Christian School diploma with more than three F's remediated outside of Oaks Christian School.

> No students will be allowed to begin Grade 11 or 12 with non-remediated F's in graduation requirements. All remediation must be completed by August 1 prior to the first day of school.
>

Any student in Grades 11 or 12 meeting the criteria for Academic Probation at the quarter will be assigned mandatory learning supports and ineligible for off-campus privileges. Failure to attend assigned supports (even with an excused absence) may result in further consequence, including the potential of dismissal from Oaks Christian School.

Although earned grades of D’s earn credit towards high school graduation, they may have to be remediated in order to be eligible for four-year college/university admittance.

Academic Integrity

Original handbook page

Why Academic Integrity Matters
Definitions of Academic Dishonesty
Procedure for Violating Academic Integrity Code
Consequences of Violating the Academic Integrity Code
Artificial Intelligence
Devices

Academic integrity is honesty in a scholastic environment. It is a particularly important part of the educational process at Oaks Christian School. Academic integrity is a key component of a student's moral character and is essential for the development of the whole person within a Christian learning environment. Academic integrity is also a key component of the entire school's moral character and is essential for the development of an academic climate of mutual trust and of a spiritual community where honesty and respect prevail. Academic integrity needs to be upheld by students and staff alike, and how well this is done will determine the quality of students who attend Oaks Christian School, now and in the future.

The following Academic Integrity Code clearly defines plagiarism, cheating, facilitation of academic dishonesty, fabrication, and violation of U.S. copyright laws. These definitions provide a framework for the training of the students and faculty so that all may glorify God through their academic work. The Academic Integrity Code also describes the clear-cut procedures and consequences that should result if intentional acts of dishonesty occur.

Why Academic Integrity Matters

The necessity of students doing their own work is an inherent part of classroom protocol and instruction. Teachers, advisors, and administration provide training and clarification for students both formally and informally through academic assemblies, freshmen adviory tech conversations, day-to-day lessons and assesments. The goal is not to police behavior but to shape character based on the understanding that how we learn is as important as what we learn.

Definitions of Academic Dishonesty

Plagiarism is the unacknowledged use of another's words or ideas (from the Latin word, plagiarius, which means "kidnapper"). This happens in many forms including but not limited to:

- Omitting a source citation for another's idea or failing to include a bibliography or works cited page when requested for an assignment.
- Copying directly from a source when you mean to paraphrase.
- Neglecting to place quotation marks around another writer's words.
- Putting your name on a group project in which others in the group have done most or all the work.

Claiming significant portions of text as your own when they are in fact copied from a source.

Summarizing or paraphrasing another's idea, thought, or concept without acknowledging the source.

Cheating is the use of unauthorized materials, information, or study aids in an academic exercise. Cheating can also be a secret agreement made among students in visual or oral form for fraudulent purposes.

Copying or receiving an answer on an assessment (e.g., test, quiz, or any other coursework that is evaluated by your teacher).

Using any unauthorized source of information during an assessment.

Acquiring specific knowledge of the content of an assessment before it is given.

Illegally obtaining a copy of an assessment before it is given.

Changing an answer on a graded assessment and then claiming the teacher made a grading error.

Copying homework or other class work.

Using a paper, in whole or part, written by another person.

Submitting the same work or major portions of the same work for two classes without permission.

Using an on-line translator for foreign language classes.

Facilitating academic dishonesty occurs when one student knowingly or negligently aids others or allows his or her work to be used in a dishonest academic manner. Such students are equally as guilty of an academic integrity violation as the recipients of their aid.

Not reporting knowledge of a violation of the Academic Integrity.

Providing false or misleading information during an investigation of a possible Academic Integrity violation.

Allowing another person to copy homework or other class work.

Not preventing your work from being easily seen or copied by another student or copied during an assessment.

Verbally, visually, or in writing helping another person during an assessment.

Accepting, sharing, or distributing a copy of an assessment before it is given.

Accepting, sharing, or distributing knowledge of an assessment before it is given.

Providing a student with an assessment or completed assignment from a previous semester or year.

Fabrication is the exaggeration or falsification of research data or survey results.

Including data collected or generated by another person in any portion of a report related to a laboratory or classroom activity.

Presenting data that does not accurately reflect your actual results in any portion of a report related to a laboratory or classroom activity.

Creating or modifying data to support any interpretations or conclusions more strongly in any portion of a report related to a laboratory or classroom activity.

The use of artificial intelligence (chatGPT, Photomath, Google translate, Calculator, etc.) is not allowed to be presented as authentic work without teacher approval. Any use of such software will be treated as a violation of our academic integrity code outlined by the process below.

Violation of U.S. Copyright Law occurs when a person copies, creates, or uses unauthorized copies of software, videos, songs, or printed materials that are copyrighted or trademarked. Limited use of these materials in an educational setting is allowed provided it includes full copyright information and follows all other guidelines set forth by U.S. Copyright Law. More information can be found at www.copyright.gov for copyright law and at www.uspto.gov for trademark law.

- Using an image from a print or electronic source as part of your work without providing full copyright information.
- Using music or other recording without providing full copyright information.
- Using an icon, character, name, phrase, or slogan, or any other trademarked material without including the ® symbol.

Procedure for Violating Academic Integrity Code

If a faculty member suspects a student dishonesty, s/he should first meet with the student, discuss the suspicions, and evaluate the evidence to see if there is some acceptable explanation for the apparent violation. If there is evidence of a violation, the faculty member will provide the Senior Academic Dean a detailed explanation of the offense and a summary of the conversation with the student. The Senior Academic Dean will follow-up with the student and assign appropriate consequeces.

Consequences of Violating the Academic Integrity Code

The Academic Integrity Code includes the varying forms of academic dishonesty and specifies three levels of consequences. Ranging from teacher intervention to dismissal from school, these consequences may also include the student not earning credit for the assignment, parental contact, school detention, notation on the student's official school transcript, and/or suspension.

- Consequence: Level One
  - Meeting Academic Dean to go over Academic Integrity policy
  - Phone conference with parents
  - Behavior consequence as determined by offense
  - Opportunity to make up assignment for full credit at the discretion of the teacher
- Consequence: Level Two
  - Meeting with parents and Academic Dean/Principal
  - Academic Consequence (grade penalty) determined by Academic Dean/Principal
  - Behavior consequence, up to suspension, determined by the Deans of Student Life.
  - May be reported to college/university
  - Contract between school and student/parents outlining consequence of a subsequent violation
- Consequence: Level Three
  - Meeting with parents, Principal, Associate Head of School, and/or Head of School
  - Behavior consequence, up to removal from Oaks Christian School

Reported to college/university

Artificial Intelligence

A detailed articulation of our school's thinking about burgeoning technologies such as LLMs is linked here: AI Philosophy and Guidelines.docx. The table below gives you a general overview of those ideas.

OCS AI Stance at a Glance

Biblical and Philosophical Worldview				
We believe that education exists for the purpose of building, developing, and refining the image of God within our students. It is a process of becoming fully human. Jesus states the two fundamental commandments as loving God with all our hearts, with all our souls, with all our minds, and with all our strengths and to love our neighbors as ourselves				
Purpose of Education				
Character Transformation		Positive Contribution		
Education is teaching human beings to see, to attend, to engage, to create, to contribute, to live as God created and intended.		Technology should assist students in this development, enabling them to contribute what is both good and useful.		
Competencies				
Ethical	Social		Technical	
Maintain ethical boundaries of authorship, privacy, and transparency.	Stewardship should guide progress.		Foundational knowledge of the tool's design, context, and history should inform choice.	
Guidelines				
Timeline	Transparency	Thoughtfulness	Tracking	Trust
The use of Large Language Models should be primarily reserved for junior- and senior-level classes.	When AI is used as part of the generative process for teachers or students, it must be acknowledged through some form of citation.	When AI is included as a formal part of an assignment or assessment, there should be a reflective conversation beforehand to vet purpose and competencies.	Design graded assignments and assessments that require meaningful interaction with ideas and can be verified as authentic.	. When student work seems compromised, address the concern with the student individually and seek learning and growth as the result.

Devices

Electronic Devices—Oaks Christian School is considered a BYOD campus. Laptops and tablets may be used in the classroom only at the discretion of the teacher. At no time may a student record, store or transmit any sensitive information (such as from a quiz or test) from any device. Students are not allowed to record any video or audio in the classroom unless granted permission by the teacher.

Calculators—At no time may calculators (or other devices) be shared between students on quizzes, tests, or examinations.

Student Academic Supports

Original handbook page

ACADEMIC SUPPORT

Oaks offers many ways for students to get extra support in their academic pursuits.

Teachers: Any student having difficulties in a class should, of course, discuss that immediately with the teacher for extra help. Students should never wait until just before tests or the end of a grading period for such help; they should go as soon as they have difficulty in understanding material. Teachers' office hours are posted on their course Bulletin Board in AXIS.

The OC Learning Center—The Oaks Christian Learning Center serves students in all core subject areas, including honors and many AP level classes. A variety of programs are offered to support the academic needs of all students, including Drop-in small group tutoring, personalized one-on-one tutoring, executive function support, summer workshops, and final exam review sessions.

Tutoring—The first responsibility of a student who faces difficulty in a class is to meet with that teacher. Teachers have posted office hours during open periods, lunchtime or after school. Students struggling academically are encouraged to attend small group Drop-in tutoring and/or sign up for individual tutoring with the Learning Center. Appointments for tutoring are available for a fee during the school day, after school, in the evenings and, occasionally, on weekends. In-person and remote tutoring options are available. The Learning Center also offers summer workshops for enrichment as well as 1:1 appointments.

Drop-in Tutoring is available to all high school students during the school day at no additional charge.

> Students may not miss a class for tutoring or they will be considered truant.
>
> Students may not miss chapel, advisory or assembly for tutoring.

Academic Seminar: Academic Seminar is a fee-based elective which provides executive functioning and academic support in a small group. Instructors check-in with each student to collaborate on grade and assignment tracking, organization, study skills, etc. Academic support is available in all core subjects.

ROAR Program (Resiliency through Opportunities, Accessibility, and Resources): The ROAR program supports students with learning differences. OCS is committed to providing equal access to the curriculum for students with diagnosed disabilities (learning, attention, mental health, medical, etc.). Although we do not provide modifications of curriculum, school accommodations do include supports such as extended time on quizzes/tests; class note-taking assistance, and preferential seating. To determine eligibility for accommodations, the student and his/her parents must meet with a High School Learning Specialist to discuss the student's psychoeducational or neuropsychological evaluation and to determine what accommodation(s) may be provided. The High School Learning Specialists will also assist students in requesting accommodations for standardized tests such as the PSAT, SAT, ACT and AP exams. The High School Learning Specialists partner with teachers, tutors, educational specialists, and psychologists, as we provide a supportive team for each student.

English Language Services—Oaks Christian High School offers an English Language Support Program (ELSP) geared to increase English proficiency through our Learning Center and ROAR Office. Students in this program will receive specialized English Language tutoring sessions throughout the school year and are eligible to receive academic accommodations. The program is designed to help students gain confidence in their communication skills not only for academic growth but also for the purpose of building healthy social relationships at Oaks Christian School.

The Sharon S. Hanes Library

Original handbook page

Library, Atrium, and Study Rooms
Technology and Circulation Policies

We believe that strong school libraries build strong students and lifelong learners by providing dedicated spaces to think, discuss, and collaborate. The Sharon S. Hanes Library and the connected Atrium are the symbolic center of the Oaks Christian High School campus and the academic hub of school life.

As students walk in the main entrance, they see reservable rooms for both private and group study. The main library space opens to carefully arranged study desks, designated conversation areas, and an open classroom for collaboration and research. Beyond the glass doors at the north end, the Atrium provides a beautiful, enclosed outdoor space for individuals, group study, and teachers and students to engage in roundtable discussions and open-air discourses in a creative, fresh way. Every inch of the space is intended as a productive, scholarly environment to promote the flourishing growth of our students.

Our highly qualified library staff have curated distinctive resources that students can explore critical thought about diverse content to deepen their intelligence, wisdom, and understanding. We currently house over 10,000 print books with room for growth. In addition to the library's holdings, active subscriptions to eMagazines, eNewspapers, and eBooks & databases provide current information. Our library staff are available to answer questions and support students in accessing and using both digital and print resources at any time—before, during, and after school.

To match constantly changing technologies, we work to provide flexible, ongoing support, and students are an integral part of this process. The Student Library Committee and the head librarian meet regularly to gather input and make decisions on collection development, library culture, and services. Our commitment to students is to do all that we can to prepare their minds for leadership and their hearts for service through wherever fields of interest and calling lead them.

The library is an active member of the Independent School Library in Southern California, as well as the American Library Association, American Association of School Librarians, Association of Independent School Librarians, Young Adult Services Association, California School Library Association, and California Library Association.

Library, Atrium, and Study Rooms

> The library and atrium are for individual and collaborative academic work.
>
> The study rooms are for silent studies and group academic work by reservation only.
>
> Food and plastic drinks are not permitted in the library.
>
> Please treat others with respect.
>
> Use of the library is a privilege. Those whose conduct impairs others' ability to work will be asked to leave.

Technology and Circulation Policies

- Technology devices are only for academic work and must be silent mode.
- Laptops, chargers, and headphones are available to use at school only.
- Keep computer, email, and AXIS passwords private; do not share with friends.
- Students will be charged late, repair, or replacement costs for any late, damaged, or lost library items.
- Wireless printing is available; ask staff for assistance.
- Overdue notices are sent via AXIS messages.

Resource	Check-Out Time	Late Fine
Academic Database	Available online	N/A
Print Book	14 days (renewable)	$1.00/day
Sora/Overdrive eBook; Flipster eMagazine	14 days (renewable)	N/A
Textbook	1 school day	$10.00/day
Class Supplemental Book	1 school day	$1.00/day
Laptop (on-campus use only)	1 school day	$10.00/day
Laptop Charger (on-campus use only)	1 school day	$10.00/day
Black & white print/copy: 15¢/page	N/A	N/A
Color print/copy: 25¢/page	N/A	N/A

High School Library Staff Contact Information

Head Librarian	Mrs. Diana Kim-Yoon, M.L.I.S.
Library Assistant	Mrs. Danica Lopez, B.S.
Library phone number: 818-575-9230	Librarian's email: dkkim@oakschristian.org

Parent Communication Protocol

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When any situation with a teacher arises in which a parent deems it necessary to be involved, proper protocol dictates that parents should first go to the teacher to resolve the situation. Administrators will direct all communication back to the teacher.

Teachers can be contacted through their email addresses posted on AXIS.

Student Life

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AWARDS AND RECOGNITION
CLUBS AND ACTIVITIES

Overview — Oaks Christian School provides activities and programs in which students gain valuable learning experiences that will prepare their minds for leadership and hearts for service. These experiences are an important extension of the classroom and are designed to support the academic and spiritual goals of the school. Oaks Christian School strives to create a culture in which all students find and develop their own interests so that each student may become an essential part of the OCS community. All questions or concerns regarding student life are to be directed to the deans of student life and/or the activities director.

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Oaks Christian School recognizes students for their achievements. Most of the recognition is reserved for upper-level students, although some awards are granted to younger students. The awards given will reflect the school's value of student work in academics, leadership, athletics, service, and the arts. The faculty determines the recipients of most of these awards and the awards are given at special assemblies or at commencement.

CLUBS AND ACTIVITIES

Clubs — Oaks Christian School offers a variety of clubs and activities in which students may participate, enhancing their intellectual, spiritual, physical, and social skills. The Debate Team, Missions Club, Math Club, Science Club, Dance Club, and Chapel Club are several of the clubs that students may participate in at Oaks Christian School. Students interested in other clubs are to refer to the student constitution for further information. Clubs that meet off campus must get pre-approval from the school and must adhere to the school's guidelines. All clubs must represent the values, mission, and goals of the school, as stated in the school constitution.

Activities — Planned by the Prefect Board and the Class Assembly under the direction of the Activities Director, activities at Oaks Christian School include Homecoming Week, a Christmas celebration, themed dances, spirit days, and other traditional school activities.

> Student Leadership
>
> Student Leadership is made up of three branches, which include the prefect board, honor board and class assembly. The Student Constitution is a guide for Student Leadership, but the binding authority in all decisions is the school administration.

> STUDENT PUBLICATIONS AND PRODUCTIONS
>
> The Broadcast News class produces Oaks News which is shown at assemblies.

> SCHOOL RETREATS

Freshman Retreat (Colorado River Canoe Trip) — Students will develop self-confidence, class unity, and be oriented to the culture of Oaks Christian School.

Senior Retreat — Seniors will have a unique opportunity to participate in a three day, off-campus retreat to reflect on their school experiences and to plan for the next stage of their life.

STUDENT TRIPS

A variety of trips that support the mission and curriculum of Oaks Christian School are available to students at an additional fee. These trips are sponsored by the school and developed by the World Missions & Community Service Coordinator, through the Office of Spiritual Life. Past trips have served in Guatemala, Costa Rica, Mexico, Romania, China, Honduras, Hawaii, Los Angeles, Philadelphia, Haiti, and Uganda. All campus handbook rules still apply while on any Oaks Christian trip. Students are subject to discipline on and after the trip should there be a violation of any handbook rules.

SERVICE AND MISSION PROGRAM

Overview - The first Christian Core-Value of Oaks Christian School states, 'Oaks Christian School strives to be Christ-centered in all aspects of the learning environment – through action, word, and deed.' The Office of Spiritual Life is committed to evaluating the programs the school offers to students and filtering them through scripture to make certain our purpose has biblical basis. The OCS Missions and Community Service Program reflects the Biblical principles that guide our understanding of why, who and how we do missions and community service.

Why do we serve?

"He said to them, 'Go into all the world and preach the gospel to all creation." ~ Mark 16:15

"Sing to the Lord, bless His name; proclaim good tidings of His salvation from day to day. Tell of His glory among the nations, His wonderful deeds among all the peoples. For great is the Lord and greatly to be praised; He is to be feared above all gods." ~ Psalm 96:2-4

"For just as the body without the spirit is dead, so also faith without works is dead." ~ James 2:26

"He has told you, O man, what is good; and what does the Lord require of you, but to do justice, to love kindness, and to walk humbly with your God?" ~ Micah 6:8

It is clear throughout scripture that believers are not just 'asked' but commanded to love and serve one another. As a Christ-centered school, we cannot overlook or half-heartedly pursue this directive made by God to us. We will not serve out of obligation, we cannot serve to 'look good,' but we must serve generously in response to God's great love given to us. Service to others is a lifestyle, not a 'religious burden.' We serve others because Jesus instructed us to. We serve others out of obedience and devotion to Him.

Who are we called to serve?

"Pure and undefiled religionin the sight of our God and Father is this: to visit orphans and widows in their distress, and to keep oneself unstained by the world." ~ James 1:27

"You,Lord, hear the desire of the afflicted; you encourage them, and you listen to their cry, defending the fatherless and the oppressed, so that mere earthly mortals will never again strike terror." ~ Psalm 10:17-18

“The second is this, ‘You shall love your neighbor as yourself.’ There is no other commandment greater than these.” ~ Mark 12:31

“Letlove of the brethren continue. Do not neglect to show hospitality to strangers, for by this some have entertained angels without knowing it. Remember the prisoners, as though in prison with them, and those who are ill-treated, since you yourselves also are in the body.” ~ Hebrews 13:1-3

We are reminded repeatedly to “love our neighbors,” and in essence that covers everyone from family to strangers. God also points out specific people we are to defend, visit, love, and seek justice for on their behalf. It is our intention to align ourselves with ministries and pastors who serve the people that God specifies should receive our love and attention. In general, God intends for us to love EVERYONE, but He also is clear about our responsibility toward those who are on the margins of society, namely: orphans, widows, family, strangers, oppressed, fatherless, foreigners, neighbors, and prisoners.

How are we to love and serve others?

“For you were called tofreedom, brethren; only do not turn your freedom into an opportunity for the flesh, but through love serve one another. For the whole Law is fulfilled in one word, in the statement, ‘YOU SHALL LOVE YOUR NEIGHBOR AS YOURSELF.” ~ Galatians 5:13-14

“Therefore, if there is any encouragement in Christ, if there is any consolation of love, if there is anyfellowship of the Spirit, if any affection and compassion, make my joy complete by being of the same mind, maintaining the same love, united in spirit, intent on one purpose. Do nothing from selfishness or empty conceit, but with humility of mind regard one another as more important than yourselves; do not merely look out for your own personal interests, but also for the interests of others. Have this attitude in yourselves which was also in Christ Jesus, who, although He existed in the form of God, did not regard equality with God a thing to be grasped, but emptied Himself, taking the form of a bondservant, and being made in the likeness of men. Being found in appearance as a man, He humbled Himself by becoming obedient to the point of death, even death on a cross. For this reason, also, God highly exalted Him, and bestowed on Him the name, which is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee will bow, of those who are in heaven and on earth and under the earth, and that every tongue will confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of God the Father.” ~ Philippians 2:1-11

“For by grace you have been saved through faith; and that not of yourselves, it is the gift of God; not as a result of works, so that no one may boast. For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand so that we would walk in them.” ~ Ephesians 2:8-9

We can know “why” and “who,” but without understanding “how” we may unintentionally cause harm rather than bring God’s blessings. It is our intention to always engage in meaningful service locally and globally with an appreciation and knowledge of those we serve. Our desire is to partner with organizations who understand those benefiting from the ministry and make every effort to give respect and dignity to those struggling with life’s circumstances. We also want to always keep our own motives in check and refrain from activities simply for appearances, but model and teach service from Jesus’ example of unconditional love without expectation but with grace, mercy, and justice. Our motivating principles include pure love without expectation; biblical purpose and thoughtful intention, based on actual, not perceived need; understanding those being served ~ respect and dignity; humility, not the arrogance of “knowing” or “having” the solution/fix (patronizing pity and unintended superiority); compassion and grace; “doing alongside” those being served (not “doing for”) ~ to encourage, not to

create dependency; and mercy and justice together. Therefore, all OCS Missions and Community Service projects will be consistent with these principles, aiming at serving our neighbors in partnership, in the spirit of Jesus Christ, and with humility.

Community and Mission Organizations – The school offers multiple international and local mission opportunities to students, there is an application process in the fall of each school year and selection to serve on a team is not guaranteed. The school hosts a service fair each fall with over 40 local service organizations so students can find an approved project to serve to meet their service requirement. Throughout the year, the school will host or promote numerous opportunities throughout the community for students to serve.

Community Service Requirements – At the end of each semester, all high school students will receive a ‘pass’ or ‘no pass’ grade for service and posted as an advisory grade. Freshmen and sophomores are required to complete at least 10 hours of service while juniors and seniors must complete at least 15 hours to receive a ‘pass’ from their advisor. Along with these minimum requirements, each student must submit an online report describing, in detail, the nature of their service. To receive a ‘pass’ grade for fall semester, all students must complete at least 5 of the required hours and submit them online prior to the due date. Students are highly encouraged to complete community service hours during the summer before each school year.

Student Expectations

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Overview

The administration, faculty and staff of Oaks Christian School are committed to providing an exemplary education in a safe environment. The guiding principles for conduct at Oaks Christian School are found in the words of Christ in the gospel of Mark 12 regarding love: “Love your neighbor as yourself,” and Matthew 18 regarding reconciliation: “If your brother sins against you, go and show him his fault, just between the two of you.” Members of the Oaks Christian School community treat each other with respect, dignity, and kindness. Led by the Deans of Student Life, Oaks Christian School will work with parents during the discipline process. Students who are unable to meet the student conduct standards set by the school will not be able to remain at Oaks Christian School. The key aspect of this process is finding students that best fit the mission and goals of the school. The admission process affords the school this important distinctive. Oaks Christian School believes that students enter school for serious reasons and that, in general, their consciences and

common sense are sufficient guides for their behavior. A sense of responsibility for one's own conduct as well as for the general well-being of the community is expected.

Any discussion of discipline must begin with self-discipline. The teachings of Paul, found in Galatians 5, regarding the Spirit-controlled life and the teaching in James 3 regarding how we speak, stress the importance of self-control. As students mature, they become less dependent on rules to govern their behavior, and more dependent on their own ability to do what is right. Our process, then, is based upon the personal integrity of students and their willingness to practice self-control. When there is a breakdown in self-discipline, peer discipline becomes important. It is crucial that friendships at our school include the willingness to confront each other in love, and thus be responsible for each other's growth in this way.

School personnel need to apply community discipline when a student exercises poor judgment, is uncooperative, or is disruptive in some way. In the classroom, teachers are responsible for maintaining the control and discipline necessary to establish a quality learning environment. The deans of student life, vice-principal, principal, and head of school support the teacher in this disciplinary role and will become involved whenever student disruption and lack of cooperation warrant their attention and sanction. Teachers are encouraged to be consistent in their disciplinary actions and to keep the discipline in line with the offense, with the goal in mind of helping students to move towards self-discipline. When appropriate, a student's advisor may be involved in the resolution process. The deans of student life, vice-principal, principal and the head of school will consult, as appropriate, on all disciplinary actions taken. The head of school shall have the final decision on all disciplinary actions. The goal of the discipline process is reconciliation and redemption. The Oaks Christian School community is encouraged to resolve matters quickly and properly. Before students can attend classes, they and their parents are required to sign off electronically on the High School Campus Handbook, agreeing to abide by all policies in the Campus Handbook as implemented by the administration, faculty, and staff of Oaks Christian School. Attendance by a student shall be deemed an agreement by the students and their parents that they have reviewed the Campus Handbook and agree to abide by all OCS policies.

Good Manners

Certain rules and expectations make learning together safe and beneficial for everyone at Oaks Christian School. The school has the right and responsibility to make and enforce these rules. Beyond these boundaries, however, there is a high degree of expectation upon students to respond and behave in such a way that demonstrates the degree of commitment students place upon themselves as members of the Oaks Christian School community.

Rights of Others

Absolute respect for the rights of others is expected of all members of the school community. Academic disruption, which includes inappropriate behavior inside or outside any class in session, in any part of the library, or in the lunch area, will not be tolerated. Rudeness, profanity, socially offensive language, or malicious behavior (physical or verbal) to faculty, staff, or peers will not be tolerated. Students involved in fighting are subject to suspension or dismissal from school, in the sole and absolute discretion of the school. Dishonesty, lying, insolence, profanity, verbal abuse, hectoring, unlawful harassment (including sexual harassment and any sort of harassment by phone, mail, social media, or email), hazing, physical abuse, or

acts endangering the safety of others are regarded as serious breaches of conduct and may result in dismissal from the school. The possession, distribution, or acquisition of pornography via the communications network at school or in hard copy is considered a serious offense and may result in dismissal from school. In addition to respecting the property belonging to the school or to others on the campus, students must respect the property of homeowners and businesses in the community. Stealing or vandalism in any form will not be tolerated and may result in dismissal. These offenses include the following: the unauthorized “borrowing” of another’s belongings, which includes entry into another’s locker, purse, book bag, or other personal item; removing food from the cafeteria without permission; removing of athletic equipment from the gym without permission; writing or carving on desks, walls, bulletin boards, or other property; or removing materials from the library without checking them out. Again, these offenses will not be tolerated and may result in dismissal.

Price Academic Center Behavior

The Price Academic Center was designed to create an atmosphere of learning. It is a place of instruction, study, and academic conversation. Social gathering and conversation should take place in the Collins Café, on the quad, or on the lawn.

Safety

The following are prohibited whenever the school is responsible for student safety on or off campus, during school-sponsored trips, and at all official school functions:

> Running, throwing balls or other objects, and playing contact sports except while being supervised
>
> Leaving campus or a school group without permission
>
> Possession or use of any gun, toy or real; fireworks or other explosives; knives, tasers, or weapons of any sort
>
> Using paint ball guns, gel blaster guns, water pistols or water balloons of any sort
>
> Skating, rollerblading, or skateboarding
>
> Commission of these offenses may lead to suspension or dismissal from the school.
>
> Wearing Student Lanyard (see lanyard policy under Safety and Security).

Restroom Violations

Restrooms at the school are gender specific and violations involving use by the opposite sex are subject to serious disciplinary consequences including, without limitation, dismissal from school. Students of the opposite gender may not be in a restroom together. Students may not be together in the same stall.

Eating

Eating is prohibited in the building unless it is done with approval. Students may have water in the classroom, building, and in the gym. Gum chewing is permitted in the classroom at the discretion of the teachers. Gum

chewing is not allowed in Calvary, Dallas Athletic Center or Bedrosian Pavilion out of respect for the speakers or performers. Students are expected to pick up after themselves and others.

Closed Campus

During school hours, students are expected to remain on campus unless they have written approval from the Office of Student Life, are on a school trip, or have been signed out by their parent or guardian. Students are expected to always have their ID. All parents and visitors are required to check in and present a driver's license when visiting during school hours. The school reserves the right to deny any person from coming onto campus at any time.

Public Display of Affection

The public display of any romantic affection — hand holding, touching, kissing, or any form of intimate contact is not allowed. Students are encouraged to develop healthy friendships. Any display of affection that is deemed distracting to the culture of Oaks Christian School is prohibited.

Gambling and Exchanges of Currency

For the security of all our students, carrying and exchanging of currency on campus is strongly discouraged. The selling of any items for any reason is not permitted. Gambling is prohibited.

Smoking/Vaping

Smoking, vaping, or the use and/or possession of any tobacco related items or e-cigarettes, is not permitted on the campus, in adjacent parking lots, on the surrounding streets, on any school bus, or when students are representing the school in public. Students who are in violation of this policy are subject to severe discipline (suspension or expulsion) as deemed appropriate by the vice principal, principal, or deans of student life.

School Dances

School sponsored dances are an important social aspect of the Oaks Christian School community. For students to fully enjoy the dance and to promote a positive environment, students are expected to abide by all school policies during the dance. Students are expected to dress in accordance with the guidelines given to them for each dance. Those students who dance inappropriately will be given a warning for the first offense, will be removed from the dance floor for a period of time for the second offense, and will be sent home after the third offense (however immediate removal from the dance and/or other disciplinary measures may occur in the sole and absolute discretion of the school). Students are to arrive during the first hour of the dance, may leave at any time after the designated release time, and are not able to return once they leave the dance. Oaks Christian students may submit a guest form to the Office of Student Life to bring a non-OCS student to school dances. Guests must be at least in high school and must be under 21 years old at the time of the school dance. All guests will need to show their school identification or a driver's license to confirm this requirement. Students are to get a guest permission slip, have their parent sign it, have the dean of

students/vice-principal from the school of the guest to sign it testifying that the student is in good standing, and must also get the approval of the Office of Student Life (Oaks Christian School reserves the right to not allow a guest to attend a school dance). This form must be returned to the Office of Student Life three days before the dance. Oaks Christian School students and their parents are responsible for the behavior of their guests and must ensure that their guests follow all Oaks Christian School policies.

Sexual Activity

It is imperative that a school maintains an educational environment. In support of this imperative, all sexual activity is prohibited, including sexual horseplay, and violations will be subject to serious consequences including but not limited to dismissal. Communication of one's sexuality that is deemed a distraction to the educational environment is subject to discipline. Students are reminded that it is unlawful in the state of California for students of any age to have any sexual contact with any person less than 18 years of age. Depending on the circumstances, all school employees are mandated reporters and must contact Child and Family Services or law enforcement.

Student Pregnancy

Our hope and prayer for each of our students is that they choose to honor the Lord by remaining sexually abstinent until marriage. Scripture is clear that sexual immorality is a sin. Scripture is also clear that all have sinned. Although we strive and desire to be Christ-like, we sometimes act in sinful and self-serving ways. Such is the case with sexual immorality. If a pregnancy results from the sexual activity of an Oaks Christian student, the sanctity of life will be honored. Oaks Christian School does not condone sex outside the confines of marriage, nor does it condone abortion. Life is a gift from God and should be treasured as such. Life should always be celebrated, preserved, and protected. It is the policy of the school to intervene when a student becomes pregnant or causes a pregnancy, and to make resulting decisions on a case-by-case basis. A pregnancy will not necessarily preclude a student from completing his/her course work at Oaks Christian School. The school's intervention, designed to be restorative in nature, is intended to encourage an atmosphere of compassion and support so that a student is strengthened in the decision to preserve the pregnancy. This policy and any resulting interventions will govern both male and female students in an equivalent manner. The final and binding determination in the matter of separation from the school lies with the head of school, which determination shall be made in his/her sole and absolute discretion.

Student Marriage

Oaks Christian School believes in the sanctity of marriage between a man and a woman. However, doing so before graduation is discouraged and may result in separation from the school. Final and binding determination in the matter of separation from the school lies with the head of school, which determination shall be made in his/her sole and absolute discretion.

BULLYING/HARASSMENT

Oaks Christian School will not tolerate harassment or bullying of any kind, whether it is of a general or specific nature. It is the policy of the school that all employees, volunteers, parents, and students will deal with all persons in ways which convey respect and consideration for individuals regardless of race, color, marital status, national origin, creed, religion, gender, age, or disability. Harassment and/or bullying includes easily identified acts of verbal, written, or physical abuse; and more subtle, but equally damaging forms of harassment and/or bullying such as graffiti, epithets, and that which is targeted at an individual or group. Physical abuse is defined as that which has the potential to cause or in fact cause physical harm, including but is not limited to pranks and any level of horseplay, whether malicious or not. The administration takes very seriously the issue of harassment of any kind and will respond accordingly and with due diligence to any violations. Any member of the Oaks Christian School community who falsely accuses another member of harassment is subject to disciplinary action.

Recording on Campus

Students are not allowed to record or take pictures on campus and post on social media (IG, TikTok, Snapchat or any other social media platform) that results in cyberbullying, slandering, demeaning or any malignment of members of the OCS community).

Cyberbullying

Although cyberbullying is likely to take place outside of normal school hours, it is something that the administration takes very seriously. Cyberbullying is broadly defined as the use of any form of electronic communication and/or technology that involves, without limitation, sexting, flaming, denigration, internet polling, sending malicious code, sending pornography, impersonations, outing, trickery, cyberstalking, harassment of any kind, intimidation, spreading rumors, manipulating social relationships, engaging in social exclusion, extortion, or intimidation, and using false profiles. Cyberbullying, regardless of the time and location the act takes place, will not be tolerated by Oaks Christian School, and will result in consequences up to and including dismissal from the school as determined in the sole discretion of the principal.

Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment is not social or courting behavior. Instead, it is the use of sexuality to harass, and is best seen as an assertion of power. Sexual harassment, for the purpose of this handbook, may include but is not limited to:

> Physical assault — including rape — or any coerced sexual relations.
>
> Pressure exerted on either an adult or a student for sexual activity or for a relationship that takes on a sexual or romantic coloring which exceeds the limit of a friendly relationship; any demeaning or repeated unwanted sexual propositions; unwelcome touching; leering at or ogling a person’s body.
>
> Sexually explicit or suggestive remarks about a person’s physical attributes, clothing, or behavior; sexually stereotyped or sexually charged insults, humor, or verbal abuse; and inappropriate personal questions.

> Sexual harassment through the use of social media is prohibited. The school reserves the right to report cyberbullying and sexual harassment to the local authorities.

> Members of the OCS community are encouraged to report any incident to a person of authority, such as a faculty person, student Advisor, or an administrator. All persons in the OCS community are obliged to take each instance seriously and inform the deans of student life, vice principal, principal, or head of school. OCS may use Chapel and/or Advisory time to educate the school community regarding this issue.

Anonymous Alerts

The OCS community has integrated the services of a third-party company that addresses the growing problem of bullying and harassment. Anonymous Alerts® enables students to report bullying quickly and anonymously, cyberbullying, depression, family problems, drug and alcohol abuse, gang-related issues, sexual harassment, guns/weapons in schools, theft/vandalism or unusual student behavior which may warrant immediate attention by school officials. The system is simple and secure for students and school officials. https://www.anonymousalerts.com/oakschristianschool

> Incidents can be anonymously submitted to school officials through the OCS website (see quick links or click here) Student can establish a 1-way or 2-way dialogue with school official(s) Students can attach/upload a photo or screen shot to any incident report iPhone, iPad, smartphone, or tablet app for quick student access

False Allegations of Harassment/ Bullying

All accusations of harassment and/ or bullying, of any nature, will be treated seriously and fully investigated. Upon conclusion of the investigation, if the accusations are proven false, the person(s) who made the claim will be subject to appropriate discipline, including but not limited to, suspension and dismissal from the school.

Dress Code Policy

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School Uniform Expectations
School Uniform Violations (Consequences)
School Events Dress

Overview- The standard of dress at Oaks Christian School is designed to contribute positively to the learning environment, express pride in being a member of the Oaks Christian School community, as well as to develop professionalism in both personal character & appearance. Students are expected to reflect the value of modesty. The options presented are affordable and provide students with choices. The school uniform expectations and consequences are clearly stated so that students may be successful in meeting the school's expectations. Grooming and accessory standards apply any time a student is representing Oaks Christian School, including, but not limited to, sports practices and games, theatre performances, school dances/activities, etc. Any questions or concerns regarding the school uniform are to be directed to the Deans of Student Life. The Administration reserves the right to make changes to the uniform policy at any time.

School Uniform Expectations

Oaks Christian High School uniform expectations are as follows:

> Clothing — On normal dress days, students are to wear clothing as listed below while on campus. Clothing must be clean, worn in good taste and the appropriate size and length. Uniforms may be purchased from Land's End and from Malachi's Closet. Students may only wear what is listed below. Students are expected to be in school uniform during school hours unless the student is actively participating in a dance class or strength & conditioning class. Permission for special non-uniform dress is only granted by the Office of Student Life.
>
> Shirts — Polo or Oxford shirts (OCS logo). Students must always wear a school approved shirt. Polo shirt colors include white, cardinal, black, and gray. Oxford shirts may be white only. Only the top button of an Oxford shirt may be unbuttoned. Students may wear a school tie with the Oxford shirt if desired.
>
> White or black short-sleeved undershirts may only be worn under polo or oxford shirts
>
> OCS Pants or shorts — Dress pants or shorts from Land's End with OCS logo (khaki or black). Shorts may not be shorter than 4 inches above the knee.
>
> Plain Casual Dress Pants – Khaki or Black ONLY
>
> > NO colored or white stitching.
> >
> > NO cargo pants.
> >
> > NO athletic shorts, sweatpants or joggers (this includes OC joggers/sweatpants/shorts)
> >
> > Correct fitting pants (if oversized, please wear belt)
> >
> > Pants should be worn around the waist with belt loops showing. No folded down pants.

Sweaters — Black or cardinal V-neck sweaters and gray and white cardigan with OCS logo. No other sweaters are authorized.

Outerwear — Students may wear an approved OCS athletic/spirit/leadership sweatshirt over an Oaks polo or oxford. Juniors and Seniors may also wear a collegiate sweatshirt, over an Oaks polo or oxford, which must be a solid color and distinctly display the name of the college/university.

Hats and Visors — Students, when indoors, are to remove any hat or head covering, including sweatshirt hoods. Students are permitted to wear hats outdoors.

ONLY OCS

Shoes — Proper shoes with laces are required. For safety and appearance reasons, shoes without laces, beach sandals, combat boots, shoes open at the toe or heel, slippers, slides or shoes with a heel more than two inches are never allowed to be worn by students at school. Shoes with heels more than two inches may be worn during formal dress occasions when approved by the school. CROCS are not allowed to be worn on campus.

Grooming and Accessories —Hair may only be natural colors (extreme designs and unnatural colors are not permitted) and must be well groomed. Hair designs that are extreme and deemed a distraction are prohibited. Distracting haircuts are not allowed (as determined by the Office of Student Life). No designs or words may be carved into the hair.

- Hair color may only be a shade that occurs naturally. A colorful highlight or accent is acceptable.
- For boys, facial hair (long sideburns, beards, and mustaches) must be clean, close to the face and well groomed.
- Jewelry is to be modest. Visible body piercings (eyebrow piercing, lip piercing, etc.) are not allowed (including tongue piercing), except for earrings. Nose piercings are allowed only if it is a small and discreet stud (at the discretion of the Office of Student Life).
- Tattoos are not to be displayed. Tattoos must be covered up by long sleeve clothing or arm sleeves during OCS functions (school day, extra-curricular activities, and sports).
- At no time shall students wear any article of clothing, jewelry or make-up or carry any item (e.g., notebook, folder, or backpack) that displays alcohol/tobacco/cannabis brands, offensive words, inappropriate products, political slogans, or image that does not support the values, rules, or philosophy of Oaks Christian School.

School Uniform Violations (Consequences)

The entire Oaks Christian School community, including faculty, staff, parents, and students, is responsible for making sure that students follow the campus wear expectations set by the school. Students who do not follow the school guidelines will be sent to the Office of Student Life and will be required to be in school uniform before returning to class. Repeated violations of the uniform will result in consequences (see below). Each offense will be recorded in AXIS under the student's conduct section.

1st Offense – Warning is issued. Student must change into school uniform or wait for a parent to bring appropriate uniform items(s) to return to class. Parent(s) will receive an automated message.

2nd Offense – Student must change into school uniform or wait for a parent to bring appropriate uniform items(s) to return to class. A communication will be sent to the parent.

3rd Offense – Student must change into school uniform or wait for a parent to bring appropriate uniform items(s) to return to class. Parent(s) will be contacted by one of the Deans of Student Life.

4th Offense – Student must change into school uniform or wait for a parent to bring appropriate uniform items(s) to return to class. Parent(s) and student will meet with members of the school administration regarding the school uniform infraction, and the student will be placed on a behavior contract.

5th Offense – Student may receive a suspension for non-compliance of school uniform expectations.

6th Offense – Student will be placed on an enrollment hold. Parent(s) and student may be required to meet with the Senior Administration Team.

School Events Dress

Students are expected to dress appropriately during school events when school uniform is not required, such as, but not limited to, non-uniform dress days, athletic and performing arts events, dances, service trips, and other school-related activities. Choices made by students should reflect the values of Oaks Christian School. Dress for concerts, theater performances or art shows shall include neat, clean pants (no jeans) and a nice shirt (no T-shirts), with the option of an appropriate skirt or dress for girls (per the Arts Department). All clothing should fit appropriately.

Specific guidelines will be given as needed during non-uniform dress days.

Attendance

Original handbook page

Attendance Office —818.575.9258 or agreason@oakschristian.org

The administration reserves the right to change the attendance policy before or during the school year.

Overview
School Approved Absence
General Absences (Parent Reported)
Unexcused Absences
All Day Absences
Missed Assessment Classes/Day
Participation and Attendance
Excessive Tardy Policy
Truancy Policy

Overview

The classroom is a center of learning activity. Missing a class means that a student will miss the class activity, important instructions, class discussion, and the interpretations given by a teacher. Students are expected to be present at all classes, meetings, chapels, advisories and assemblies at Oaks Christian School. Curriculum-related activities such as field trips and retreats are considered part of the curriculum. Oaks Christian School reserves the right to review a student's attendance records regarding the issuance of academic credit and completion of course work and may withhold credits if the student's attendance record is deemed to be insufficient. When it becomes necessary for a student to miss school, parents are expected to inform the school, if possible, ahead of time. If a parent is unable to inform the school prior to the absence, a parent phone call or email must be received within 72 hours of the absence or it will be deemed an Unreported Absence (Unexcused). If a student/parent does not clear an absence within 72 hours, the student will be asked to clear the absence with the attendance officer immediately before re-entering a class. The school reserves the right to remove from school any student with excessive unexcused absences. In such cases, the school shall report that student to the county school superintendent of the area in which the student resides in compliance with compulsory attendance laws. Absences are divided into the following categories:

School Approved Absence

Athletic, Medical, College Tours, College Rep Visit, Health Office, Field Trip

> School approved athletic games, field trips/activities (requires signatures from each teacher)
>
> Medical appointments or medically mandated absences (concussion, contagious illnesses, etc.). Physical therapy appointments must be made before school, after school, lunchtime or during open periods. These appointments cannot be made in place of assemblies, chapels, or advisory times.

> College Visits requires permission forms with signatures required from parents, college counselor and each teacher- three days per academic year are allowed for this purpose.

> Students can miss each class one time for an on-campus college rep visit if the teacher approves for the student to miss class and the student uses the permission form. Additional class periods may be missed but the teacher needs to grant permission. Permission forms are available in the College Counseling Office and must be given to the teacher at least two days prior to the college rep visit.

> Pre-approved absences authorized by the Office of Student Life: religious observance, family emergency, funeral, professional endeavors, court mandated subpoena, etc.

Students who plan to participate in athletics, mission trips, school trips, college visits, arts performances, school activities or any pre-approved absences ought to be strategic in minimizing the number of absences throughout the semester and communicate with the faculty regarding expectations. It is the responsibility of the student to schedule with the teacher and hold to the appointment time and day. Missing a student-teacher appointment is the equivalent of an unexcused absence. Student-athletes are expected to arrange for any missed assessments and/or turn in assignments before the absence.

General Absences (Parent Reported)

(Traffic, Personal Appointments, Sleeping In, Sick per Parent, In-School Detention) are not school approved absences.

> Sleeping in, normal commuter traffic, transportation Issues

> Personal appointments, trips, or personal business

> Transportation issues/car problems/traffic

> In School Detention (All Day)

> In School Detention: No grade reduction in assignments or assessments. The consequence of an In-School Detention is not being able to attend class or socialize with his/her peers. No missed class material will be taught to the student during teacher office hours.

> If a student has a Parent Reported Absence on the day of an assessment, the first occurrence is a warning, all other occurrences are a 15% grade reduction.

Unexcused Absences

(Truant, Suspension, No Excuse/Unreported)

> Mix-up with schedule

> Skipping classes on purpose or by accident is considered a TRUANCY and a consequence will be assigned.

> Unreported Absences (after 72 hours): Students may not receive credit for assignments/assessments and a consequence may be assigned.

> School Suspension

> If a student is truant, there will be a grade reduction on the assignment/assessment per each department policy.

> If a student is suspended, there will be an automatic 15% grade reduction on assignments if the assignment is completed by the teacher's scheduled appointment.

Except for suspensions, students are to turn in all missed assignments the day they return to school. Tests assigned before the absence that occur during the absence should be taken the day the student returns to school. If a student is absent for more than 3 days, a student must do all schoolwork within a period of time equal to the number of days absent unless other arrangements have been made with his/her teachers.

All Day Absences

To report an absence, parents must contact the Attendance Office by one of two methods:

(1) PREFERRED: Record absence/early release/or late arrival in AXIS.

(2) Only to be used after absence has occurred: Email (agreason@oakschristian.org)

Upon returning to school after an all-day absence, students are to report directly to their classes. Any student's absence(s) not reported within 72 hours will not be allowed to receive full credit for any of the assignments/assessments due on the day(s) of the absence(s). It is the responsibility of the student to have a parent/guardian communicate with the attendance office to clear an absence.

The attendance office will notify parents via BrightArrow (Text and/or Email) each day of any unreported absence. It is the responsibility of the student and parent(s) to check attendance through the school's Learning Management System (AXIS). Parents must clear a student's absence within 72 hours using AXIS or contacting the school attendance officer.

Missed Assessment Classes/Day

> Parent Reported/Excused Absence: Students who are absent on an assessment day, even if it is parent reported, will receive a warning for the first absence. Each subsequent absence on an assessment day will result in a grade penalty of 15% on the assessment. Any exception to this rule must be made by administration (see Attendance Policy above).

> Unexcused Absence: Students who have an unexcused absence (including truancy) will receive a 15% reduction on assessments missed due to the absence. This includes any student found on campus with a reported excused absence. This is independent of any behavioral consequence based on repeated behavior.

> Excused Absence on Day of Assessment: Any student missing class on the day of the assessment has five school days to make up the missed assessment in the Oaks Christian Test Center or an agreed arrangement with their teacher. Failure to do so will result in a grade penalty of 50%. Any exception to this rule must be approved by the school administration.

> AP/Honors students who are absent from their assessments repeatedly (e.g., 2 or 3 missed assessment) in a class will be removed from the AP or Honors class and assigned to a CP class (unless chronic or catastrophic illness, excused by doctor's note).

Participation and Attendance

Teachers may incorporate into their CMP a participation grade that is determined by active class participation. Participation is dependent on student attendance. This will be determined by individual departments that require a greater level of participation in class.

EXCESSIVE ABSENCE POLICY

Good attendance at school is one important way to maintain student achievement. When a student accumulates non-school approved absences, the following steps will be taken to counsel the student and family.

Individual class absences per semester:

Level 1 - 5 absences (non-school approved) within the semester results in the school notifying the parent.

Level 2 – 10 absences (non-school approved) within the semester results in a parent phone call.

Level 3 – 18 absences (non-school approved) within the semester results in meeting with the Academic Dean/Principal/Head of School, “no credit” to be earned for the course, and the student may not be allowed to participate in any extracurricular activities (Athletics or Performing Arts) for the remainder of the semester. If the class is a graduation requirement, then the student must retake the course in summer school, retake the course the next school year or enroll in an online course through OCO.

> Any absences that are not school approved will count toward the absence total.
>
> * The excessive absence policy applies to assemblies, chapel, advisory, on-campus tutoring, Freshmen Bridge and Academic Seminar.

When situations arise in which a student is excessively absent for reasons beyond his/her control, the school will make every effort to work with the family to act in the best interest of the student.

Family vacations — Parents and students are asked to carefully review the school’s vacation schedule and to make travel plans well in advance to avoid missing any school days. When it is necessary for a student to miss school, parents are expected to contact the Office of Student Life at least two weeks in advance to make the appropriate academic arrangements and submit a pre-approved absence request.

Pre-Approved absence requests —Any requests will be handled through the Office of Student Life by completing a Pre-approved Absence form that may be picked up from the Office of Student Life.

Chapel and Community Assembly Attendance—Chapel and Community Assembly are important events in the Oaks Christian School community. As such, attendance is an expectation.

> Students who do not attend Chapel, Community Assembly, or Advisory will NOT be allowed to participate in school athletics (practices and contests), the arts (performances and rehearsals), nor any other school activities that day.
>
> Excessive absences from chapel and community assembly could result in, but are not limited to:
>
> > a meeting with school administration regarding absences
> >
> > Transition to Oaks Christian Online School
> >
> > Separation from Oaks Christian School

Participation in Athletics, Arts, and School Activities — Any student who has missed more than 51% of their classes or academic obligations, including open periods/assemblies/chapels/advisories in a given day may not participate in athletics, arts, nor school activities that day unless s/he has been granted an exception by the Office of Student Life.

> Any student who is absent from Chapel or Community Assembly, for any reason, will NOT be allowed to participate in athletics (practices and contests), the arts (performances and practices), nor school activities.
>
> All students must physically attend 51% of their classes or academic obligations, including open periods in a given day or remain on campus the equivalent of 51%, in order to participate in athletics (practices and contests), arts (performances and rehearsals) or school activities.
>
> Off campus appointments must be scheduled at the discretion of the parent so that students attend the minimum number of hours for permission to participate in any kind of school activity (practices, games, rehearsals, performances, etc.).
>
> Students are expected to check-in and check-out with the Office of Student Life to confirm eligibility.
>
> Students who violate this requirement will be assigned a consequence at the discretion of the Office of Student Life (such as, suspension from extracurricular activities and detention).
>
> A student who has an unserved detention from the previous month may not participate in extracurricular activities, practices or games until that detention has been served.

Tardy – Up till 15 minutes: Class tardy is defined as being up to fifteen (15) minutes late to a specific class. A student is considered absent if they are more than fifteen (15) minutes late to a class. For students to be successful in a class, it is essential that they arrive before class begins and are ready to learn when the teacher begins class. Teachers work with students in ensuring that students master this important classroom skill. Parents and students may check “Student Records” to account for their attendance records: Tardy-Excused, Tardy-Unexcused, 10+ min Tardy and absences. Students are expected to keep track of their tardies.

Tardy- Beyond 15 Minutes: The student will be marked “absence unexcused” by their teacher unless the attendance office determines that the absence is parent reported (see absence policy).

The Office of Student Life will make every effort to work with the family to act in the best interest of the student.

Unexcused tardies include:

> sleeping in
>
> transportation/carpool issues
>
> > car problems
>
> traffic
>
> schedule mix-up

Excessive Tardy Policy

Students with excessive unexcused class tardies will be held accountable per semester as follows:

- Five (5) class tardies – Student and Parent are notified about tardies and need to agree to the tardy policy in AXIS. Students and parents are asked to notify the Office of Student Life if there is a situation where the tardies are outside of their control.
- Ten (10) class tardies – Student will serve Café Clean Up during lunchtime.
- Fifteen (15) class tardies – Student will receive a lunch detention with the Office of Student Life for a length of time decided upon by the Office of Student Life. During detention, a student will prepare a presentation regarding tardies and their impact on our community.
- Twenty (20) class tardies- A student will be drafted into a behavior contract with the Office of Student Life.
- Twenty (25) class tardies- A student and parent will meet with our Vice Principal and Principal to review the Behavior Contract. This conversation can escalate to include a possible enrollment hold and conversation with our Head of School regarding re-enrollment.

Class tardies are totaled from the student's classes required assemblies, chapel/advisory and class meetings.

Student Pick-Up and Appointment Release

Leaving Early — Parents must report an early release using AXIS, with the reason and time of departure, at least two hours in advance, or there may be a delay in the student's departure. If a student leaves prior to parental permission verified by the attendance office, they will be considered truant.

- Proof of an appointment must be provided upon return to school (e.g., doctor's note)
- For student safety, parents picking up their student must come to the front desk to be verified before their student can be released.
- Students are expected to schedule their appointments before and after school and not during class, advisory, or chapel.
- Students who are driving themselves to an appointment must have a parent inform the attendance office prior to their release.
- Juniors and seniors who are done for the day must exit through the lower guard kiosk with their ID and schedule.
- Students will not be released during lunch with a parent phone call.

Truancy Policy

Oaks Christian School defines truancy as the action of staying away from school without good reason; absenteeism. This includes being on-campus, but not in the expected classroom. Any student who is found to be truant will have the following consequences:

Infraction will be placed on AXIS and an automated account of the truancy will be sent to parents. The student will receive a 0 on all coursework/homework/participation grades and a 15% grade reduction on assessments/projects/papers due on the day of the truancy.

Infraction will be placed on AXIS and an automated account of the truancy will be sent to parents along with a phone call from the Office of Student Life. The student will lose off-campus privileges (Sr. lunch, Jr.

early release, etc.). The student will receive a 0 on all coursework/homework/participation grades and a 15% grade reduction on assessments/projects/papers due on the day of the truancy.

Infraction will be placed on AXIS and an automated account of the truancy will be sent to parents. The parent(s) and student must meet with school administrators and the student will be placed on a behavior contract. The student will be given a 2-day suspension, which includes an academic penalty of 15% off all coursework/homework and 15% grade reduction on assessments. The student will receive a 0 on all coursework/homework/participation grades and a 15% grade reduction on assessments/projects/papers due on the day of the truancy.

The parent(s) and student must meet with the Senior Leadership Team to determine the student's future status with Oaks Christian School.

On Campus Truancy — Truancy is defined as an "unexcused absence" from school or a specific class without the knowledge and consent of parent/guardian and proper school authorities, for part or all of any school day. If a student is late to class by 15 minutes or more, this will be considered an unexcused absence. The consequences, not necessarily required to be in progressive order, will be determined by the Office of Student Life. Assignments and/or tests missed because of a period or full-day truancy may receive no credit.

Off Campus Truancy – A student is considered off campus truant if they are off campus at any time during the school day without permission. A student will receive an automatic off-campus suspension and may lose off-campus privileges for the remainder of the semester.

Closed Campus — Students are not allowed to arrive late or leave campus until the end of the school day except for special circumstances, including off-campus privilege, as approved by the Deans of Student Life.

Off-Campus Policy — Seniors and juniors, with signed and approved late arrival/early release forms, can sign out and leave campus after their last requirement of the day. Seniors, with an off-campus lunch permit authorized by the Deans of Student Life, may be allowed to go off campus during the lunch period. Juniors and seniors must exit through the guard kiosk and not through the front reception desk.

Visits to the Health Office — If a student becomes ill during the school day, s/he should request a pass to the health office from their teacher. Except in emergency situations, students should not go to the health office during passing periods or lunch without first reporting to the next period teacher or the attendance office to request a student pass. All students must have a pass from a teacher/dean to be seen by the nurse unless it is a medical emergency.

> No student may leave school due to an illness without first being seen by the nurse and obtaining a pass from the nurse.

> All prescription medication must be brought by the parent or legal guardian and checked in to the health office, or Office of Student Life, if health office staff is unavailable. Students in violation of this policy are subject to suspension.

> If a student is absent for more than five days and/or is hospitalized, they must have a doctor's note to return to school. Students with fevers of 100 or greater will be sent home. Students must be fever-free for 24 hours without the use of fever reducing medications before returning to school.

Lice policy: The health office must be notified if a student has head lice. If three or more students are infested, a schoolwide notice will be made. The student must be checked by the school nurse and be

cleared by the nurse to return to the school. If any live lice are found, the student will be sent home.

Assistive ambulatory devices: If a student returns to school on crutches, s/he must have a release and have been taught ambulation through that provider's office. Please do not purchase over-the-counter crutches and give them to your student without professional education or a doctor's order. Physicals: Required for all students in 9th grade, as well as any new 10th, 11th, and 12th grade students.

Acceptable Use of Technology

Original handbook page

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Acceptable Uses and Ethical Behavior
Unacceptable Uses and Unethical Behavior
Personal Electronic Devices
Overview
Smart Glasses
Headphones/Earbuds/Air pods/Laptops
Guidelines for the use of electronic devices:
Virtual Private Networks (VPNs)
Consequences

Overview

Oaks Christian School offers students, staff, and faculty a range of telecommunications technologies designed to support excellence in teaching and learning. The use of the computer and internet access is required for several classes at the school. The internet and email provide our community with access to unique resources and opportunities for collaborative work. Use of these technologies, however, is a privilege, and not a right, that must be used in an effective and ethical manner. Therefore, the use of the computers, internet and all other telecommunications technologies at the school shall be in support of education and research, shall be consistent with other school policies, and shall assure the use of computers in a responsible, efficient, ethical, and legal manner. The use of the internet and email is for school/academic issues only. Due to the rapid changes in technology, it is highly likely that some of the policies and procedures will become outdated or need to be amended. Students can expect policy changes during the school year and will be notified of these changes. The school retains the right to change technology related policies and procedures, as necessary.

Acceptable Uses and Ethical Behavior

When using technology, students, staff, and faculty are expected to adhere to the same standards of ethical behavior which govern other aspects of our school community:

Exercise good judgment when using any technology. Use personal and school technology for academic purposes only. Use all devices in appropriate and approved areas, and during appropriate and approved times.

Approved video chats must be made or taken outside (Price Academic, Calvary, Dallas Gym, Bedrosian Pavilion)

To protect your privacy and safety, do not give out your address, telephone number, or full name. You are responsible for your own privacy and protection.

Since network administrators must maintain system integrity and ensure responsible use, users should not expect files stored on the school's servers, Internet use or email communications to be private. Oaks Christian School reserves the right to review, in its sole and absolute discretion, any files stored on the school's computers or servers, internet use or email communications or any texts, message, pictures or other material contained on any computer, phone or any other electronic device or electronic storage device that is either used on school premises or is in the possession or control of a student while on the school premises. Oaks Christian School is not responsible for any information that may be transmitted or received via email or internet usage.

Students must use the STUDENT-BYOD network and must not violate the Technology Handbook: High School as listed on the Tech Resource page on AXIS (AXIS —> Resource Board —> Tech Resource Page).

Unacceptable Uses and Unethical Behavior

Any unacceptable or illegal use of technology could cause embarrassment to the user and to the school. It could even threaten freedom of access to information within our school community. Misuse includes sending or seeking to receive messages that contain or suggest racism, sexism, inappropriate language, pornography, bullying, false or misleading information, misidentification, impersonating, sexting, illegal solicitation, or information that could violate another person's privacy. Other unacceptable uses include:

Accessing websites or files that contain explicit materials or offensive language. If a student accidentally accesses one of these sites, they are expected to exit the site, close the browser, or turn off their device immediately.

Deleting or changing any application or file belonging to the network of another person. This includes deliberately attempting to bypass security software or obtaining or sharing passwords belonging to others. Giving someone else yours or anyone else's username and/or password, asking someone else to use their username and password or attempting to guess someone else's username and password is prohibited.

Trying to access other individual's or other institution's files or mail. Do not modify or copy any files/data of other users without their consent.

Forwarding another user's communication without the author's prior consent.

Using a proxy web site to access other sites that are blocked or filtered.

Copying commercial software or personal intellectual property in violation of copyright laws.

Destroying, modifying, or abusing the hardware or software in any way. We ask everyone to respect the fact that the computers are configured in a way that is most useful to most of our community and should not be changed to meet individual preferences. This includes changing cables, moving, or unplugging a mouse, keyboard, or monitor. Downloading and/or installing any software, plugins, extensions, or other code can only be done through the I.T. department.

Students, parents, and faculty should be aware of the possibility of the dangers involved with chat rooms and chat-sessions. There is no control over individuals that are communicating within these sessions, and adult language is used. Personal use is prohibited.

The school computers should not be used for commercial purposes defined as "offering or providing products or services." Students should not use the school computers for purchasing products or services.

The school will not be responsible for financial obligations arising from unauthorized purchases. Students are not allowed to buy or sell anything using school computers or the school's network or the internet connection provided by the school.

Sending out unauthorized global email. Students are not allowed to send emails to all students. Using the school's email for announcements, requests, or invitations is prohibited.

Instant messaging is not allowed on school computers, the school's network, or the internet connection provided by the school.

Using an email provider other than the school's email system and the use of email for personal (non-school related) communication.

Playing any games on school computers.

Using AI to generate or alter any videos, images, and audio of any staff, faculty or other students.

Personal Electronic Devices

Overview

To maintain respect for others and the learning environment at Oaks Christian School, the use of cell phones by students during the school day (8:30am-3:15pm), whether inside school buildings or in outdoor areas, is prohibited. Students' mobile devices must be turned off and stored in their backpack, locker, or vehicle for the entirety of the school day.

Smart Glasses

Smart Glasses may not be worn\used on any of Oaks Christian's campuses nor during any school events, which include but are not limited to athletic events, arts events, retreats, field trips, etc. This policy is in place for the protection, privacy, and safety of the members of the Oaks Christian School community, as well as to protect the integrity of our academic expectations.

Headphones/Earbuds/Air pods/Laptops

Headphones/earbuds/Air pods may not be worn during the school day. Headphones/earbuds/Air pods may only be used in the Library for academic purposes when connected to an approved electronic device. Playing music aloud is prohibited on campus during the school day.

Personal laptop computers may be used for taking notes and for assignments at the teacher's discretion. A teacher may ask a student to put the laptop away at any time if the student is using it for purposes other than approved class work. Students are responsible for the safety and security of any item that they may bring to school. Students who are unable to follow these guidelines will surrender their electronic devices.

Guidelines for the use of electronic devices:

Phones should be off and stored at the beginning of each school day. Devices may be stored in backpacks, lockers, or vehicles. Phones may not be on a student's person at any time during the school day. Smart Glasses are not allowed on any campus of Oaks Christian School.

Cell phones may not be used during chapel, community assembly, or an indoor assembly unless instructed to do so by the Office of Student Life. Smart Glasses may never be used on campus nor during school events.

Students must follow all other technology acceptable use policies and procedures.

Students may use approved electronic devices for academic purposes in the building, if they are not mobile.

Devices must not give off sound nor be a distraction to academic culture, either from a speaker or through headphones.

The school reserves the right to update this policy throughout the school year.

Virtual Private Networks (VPNs)

The use of Virtual Private Networks (VPNs) or any other technology designed to bypass, circumvent, or interfere with the school's network security systems, internet filters, monitoring tools, or access restrictions is strictly prohibited on all school-owned and personal devices while connected to school resources or participating in school activities. Students found using, attempting to use, installing, sharing, or facilitating the use of a VPN or similar service will be subject to disciplinary action as outlined in the Technology Acceptable Use Policy and related sections of this Handbook.

Consequences

The school reserves the right to limit or suspend technology access privileges to any user who is not using the school's technological resources in a responsible and ethical manner. Violation of this agreement may also result in disciplinary action. Please remember that the use of the internet and school computers is a privilege, not a right. For more clarity regarding consequences for student cell phone use during the school day, see below. Each offense will be recorded in AXIS under the student's conduct section.

> 1st offense – The device will be surrendered, and the student may pick up their device after 3:15pm from the Office of Student Life.

> 2nd offense – The device will be surrendered, and the student may pick up their device after 3:15pm from the Office of Student Life. Communication will go out to the parents/guardian regarding the infraction.

> 3rd offense – The device will be surrendered, and the student can pick up their device after 3:15pm from the Office of Student Life. Parent(s) will be contacted by one of the Deans of Student Life.

> 4th offense – The device will be surrendered, and the student can pick up their device after 3:15pm from the Office of Student Life. Parent(s) and student will meet with members of the school administration regarding the device infractions, and the student will be placed on a behavior contract.

> 5th offense – Student will receive a suspension for non-compliance with the technology policy.

6th offense – Student will be placed on an enrollment hold (seniors will lose senior privileges which may include, but are not limited to: off-campus privileges, grad night, senior prom, senior lounges, graduation). Parent(s) and student may schedule a meeting with the Senior Administration Team to discuss future enrollment status.

Athletics

Original handbook page

OVERVIEW
ELIGIBILITY FOR COMPETITION
PROCEDURES
ROLE OF COACHES, PARENTS AND SPECTATORS

OVERVIEW

The purpose of Oaks Christian Athletics is to transform lives through demonstrating Christ-like values in interscholastic sports. Coaches and Athletes strive to achieve our mission by developing positive moral character, competitive spirit, and athletic performance.

Athletics brings people together, builds school pride and spirit, and most of all helps shape lives in a positive way. At Oaks Christian, our coaches have the ability to share Christ with young athletes. This is the most important part of our athletic department. Being able to share Christ is what makes Oaks Christian so special.

Students who elect to participate in our athletic programs are making a significant commitment of their time and energy as well as taking on a responsibility to represent God, Oaks Christian, and their family. They will not just be attending Oaks, but will be OAKS CHRISTIAN, and there is a difference.

ELIGIBILITY FOR COMPETITION

Academic Requirement—To be eligible for participation in athletics, a student must meet the California Interscholastic Federation (CIF) Southern Section (SS) standards and the standards required by OCS. An athlete whose quarterly/ semester GPA is below 2.0 at the end of a mid-semester or semester grading period will be athletically ineligible for competition in a sport until the next mid-semester or semester grading period, providing the athlete has raised his/her CIF GPA to a 2.0 or higher. If an athlete falls below a 2.0 at the final grading period of the school year, the athlete will be ineligible during the first grading period of the next year. If a student attempts to improve a grade during summer school by taking the same class as that which was previously taken, the summer school grade can replace the grade received in the preceding grading period for the student's CIF GPA. However, if a student takes a different class than that which was previously taken, the summer school grade is to be averaged with all grades received in the preceding grading period. If there is a probationary period, it shall be the length of the grading period. OCS must approve all summer school classes. See the academic section of this handbook for further information on summer school credits and goals. While the athlete is ineligible, s/he may continue to practice with the team at the discretion of the Academic Office and the head coach.

Any student who has missed more than 51% of their classes or academic obligations, including open periods/assemblies/chapels/advisories in a given day may not participate in athletics that day unless s/he

has been granted an exception by the Office of Student Life. All students must physically attend 51% of their classes or academic obligations, including open periods in a given day or remain on campus the equivalent of 51%, in order to participate in athletics (practices and games). Off campus appointments must be scheduled at the discretion of the parent so that students attend the minimum number of hours for permission to participate in any kind of school activity (practices and games). Students are expected to check in and check out with the Office of Student Life to confirm eligibility. Students who violate this requirement will be assigned a consequence at the discretion of the Office of Student Life (suspension for extracurricular activities and detention). A student who has an unserved detention from the previous month may not participate in extracurricular activities, practices or games until that detention has been served.

Athletic Attendance—Attendance at the games, meets, practices, matches, and activities is mandatory. Unexcused absences may result in removal from the team.

PROCEDURES

Athletic Forms—Physicals and online athletic forms must be completed and approved prior to the first day of participation in a sport. Parents should log into their AXIS account as a parent (not with a student account) and find Magnus Health. They can then upload a completed physical to their student's account and complete the online athletic forms.

Transportation—Oaks Christian School desires to provide transportation to and from all athletic events for the participants of the contest, but on occasion, private family transportation will be needed. Bus/van rules and regulations must always be followed, or transportation privileges will be forfeited.

Whenever possible, teams are transported to and from games via a school van or chartered bus. Players are expected to travel on the van/bus and back to school unless parents are at the game to take them home. If there are players that will be carpooled by a parent, the coach must be notified by a release form that is signed by the parent.

NO STUDENT IS TO EVER TRANSPORT ANOTHER STUDENT(S) TO OR FROM A GAME OR PRACTICE.

Athletic Uniforms and Equipment—All athletes may be issued uniforms, practice gear, and specific sports equipment. School equipment not returned will be charged to the student's account at the replacement cost. Any equipment or uniforms returned after the turn-in date will not be issued a credit if the replacement uniforms or equipment has been ordered. All athletic bags and equipment are to be stored in the athletic locker rooms and not in the academic buildings or outside in the student locker area.

LETTERING

Oaks Christian School will award Varsity letters to all Varsity participants who have met the specific standards. The following will lead to earning a Varsity letter: participating in athletic competition, practice, attending team meetings and team functions, displaying sportsmanship, commitment to the team and school, and displaying an attitude of dedication and service.

ATHLETIC COMPETITION

League — As a member of the California Interscholastic Federation (CIF), OCS will compete in the Marmonte League.

Sports Offered — The following sports may be offered (teams will be offered only if there are enough participants):

> Fall: boys’ beach volleyball; boys’ water polo; cross country; football; girls’ flag football; girls' indoor volleyball; girls' tennis; girls' golf

> Winter: boys’ basketball; boys’ soccer; girls’ basketball; girls’ soccer; girls’ water polo

> Spring: baseball; boys’ golf; boys’ lacrosse; boys’ tennis; boys’ indoor volleyball; girls’ beach volleyball; girls’ lacrosse; softball; swimming; track & field

Cheer—Students may try out for the cheer program each year. Students involved in the cheer program are required to maintain the same academic requirements as other athletes to participate. Students who participate in the cheer program may also participate on an athletic team during a different season. All questions or concerns regarding the cheer program may be directed to the head cheer coach.

ROLE OF COACHES, PARENTS AND SPECTATORS

A committed and dedicated coaching staff has been selected to honor God, serve the school, and mentor the athletes. The desire at Oaks Christian School is to enter every contest by maintaining the highest level of competition and sportsmanship. Likewise, the coach mentors and helps the athlete learn how to accept losing and winning with humility and respect towards the opposing team, fans, and officials. Parents and fans must display true sportsmanship throughout the competition. The school expects coaches, players, parents, and fans to treat the officials with the greatest respect for the position they hold. Those who do not conduct themselves in this fashion will be asked not to attend the school’s athletic events.

Racial Unity Policy

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Racial Unity Policy
Statement of Policy
Oaks Christian School's Policy Statement on racial unity:
Examples of Racial Misconduct
Student Self-Advocacy
School Procedures for Addressing Complaints of Racially based misconduct
Reporting Peer to Peer racially based misconduct

Racial Unity Policy

The administration, faculty and staff of Oaks Christian School are committed to providing an exemplary education in a safe environment. The guiding principles for conduct at Oaks Christian School are found in the words of Christ in the gospel of Mark 12 regarding love: "Love your neighbor as yourself," and Matthew 18 regarding reconciliation: "If your brother sins against you, go and show him his fault, just between the two of you." Members of the Oaks Christian School community treat each other with respect, dignity, and kindness. Oaks Christian School is committed to creating a unified healthy body of Christ.

Statement of Policy

In keeping with the vision of 'One Oaks Christian,' and in fulfillment of the mission of the school, the school is committed to providing a positive Christ-filled environment; promoting; and educating students about racial diversity, understanding, value, respect, unity, and harmony in accordance with a biblical worldview.

Oaks Christian School will not condone; allow; or tolerate inappropriate negative conduct toward any individual based on a person's race, skin color, ethnicity, or national origin.

Racial misconduct includes, but is not limited to, inappropriate racial comments, slurs, jokes, pictures, objects, threats, physical or verbal assaults, harassment (including sexual), intimidation. Furthermore, intentional, or overt acts of racial misconduct may lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal from the school.

Oaks Christian School's Policy Statement on racial unity:

> Oaks Christian School believes/affirms that all persons are created in the image of God (the Imago Dei) and is dedicated to fostering a spirit of unity, harmony, acceptance, value, and hospitality among its community for all persons.

> Oaks Christian School provides equitable opportunities [fair/equal opportunities, not outcomes] for students to be involved in the three pillars of the school (Arts, Academics and Athletics).

Oaks Christian School is an educational community that values racial/ethnic/cultural diversity, acceptance and understanding leading to unity for all its community members.

Oaks Christian School strives to provide an environment free of inappropriate treatment of individuals due solely to race, ethnicity, skin color, or national origin.

Oaks Christian School does not tolerate inappropriate introduction or discussion of race/ethnicity in the classroom environment or on the campus.

Oaks Christian School does not allow the introduction of labels; apparel; signage; protestations; actions; demonstrations; etc., regarding racial, social, social justice matters, support for or promotion of outside groups or movements; or political subject matter on campus at any time without the prior approval of the Head of School.

Examples of Racial Misconduct

unwelcome comments and conduct with racial connotation(s) or subject matter that may reasonably be demeaning to an ethnic group or people of a particular skin color or group

offensive and vulgar jokes, name-calling, ridicule or mockery, insults, or put-downs, acts of bullying, stereotyping based on a person's skin color, ethnicity, or national origin, physical gestures, or enactments, or displaying racist photographs or objects; that a reasonable person may find offensive

entitlements, requests or demands for favorable treatment due solely to one's skin color, ethnicity, race, or national origin.

bullying, acts of harassment (including sexual), physical assaults or threats and intimidation based on one's skin color, ethnicity, race, or national origin.

denial or obstruction of access to programs or services based solely on one's skin color, ethnicity, race, or national origin.

any other racial misconduct that may be reasonably understood to interfere with, or distract from, an individual's work or academic performance.

any of these examples as it is used on social media (Facebook; Instagram; Tik Tok, etc.), electronic communication (phones; tablets; iPods), or on remote learning platforms (e.g., Axis, Zoom, Desmos, etc.).

Student Self-Advocacy

Students are encouraged to speak to a member of the high school administration, faculty, or staff member to report any incident or concern regarding racial misconduct by a student, faculty, administration, or staff member. This may include but is not limited to:

offensive and vulgar jokes, name-calling, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, stereotyping based on a person's skin color, ethnicity, or national origin, physical gestures, or enactments, or displaying racist photographs or objects. (Reasonable Person Standard).

denial or obstruction of access to services based on one's skin color, ethnicity, race or national origin.

> Entitlements, requests or demands for favorable treatment because of one’s skin color, ethnicity, race, or national origin.
>
> unequal application of school policies (including discipline) based on one’s skin color, ethnicity, race, or national origin.

School Procedures for Addressing Complaints of Racially based misconduct

After receiving the complaint, the Office of Student Life will investigate the allegations, interview all parties that were involved and witnessed the incident and report to the High School Principal and the Head of School. The final decision (including any decision to terminate enrollment which will be at the sole discretion of the Head of School) will be a private matter and not disclosed to the school community.

Reporting Peer to Peer racially based misconduct

- Office of Student Life: Students may report racial misconduct to any member of the Office of Student Life.
  - If the concern is about a student, the information will be shared with the Office of Student Life.
  - If the concern is about an employee of Oaks Christian, the information will be shared with the appropriate principal or supervisor.
- Racial Misconduct Reporting. Any report can be communicated to the Office of Student Life by email or in person. (Anonymous Alerts is available so that a staff member can investigate an incident, but limited action can be taken due to the anonymity of the report)

Discipline Policy

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Overview
Procedure
Levels of Consequences
School Discipline: Zero-Tolerance and Restorative Policy
Possession or Use of Illegal Drugs, Alcohol and Performance Enhancing Drugs
Four Step Policy
Student Expectations Summary
Restorative Justice Approach to Student Discipline

Overview

Oaks Christian School views discipline as a redemptive tool in the process of building character. It is critical for students to understand the value of discipline within this framework. Otherwise, s/he will have a challenging time moving forward after a disciplinary action.

Procedure

Students who break the rules are referred to the deans of student life, vice principal, principal, or head of school. A student or students, if it is warranted, may be immediately removed from a class. Otherwise, a faculty or staff member will inform the deans of student life of an incident via a written referral. The deans will follow up with the student or students and, as needed, with the faculty or staff member. The goal of such a meeting is to understand what happened, for the student or students to reconcile themselves to other people involved as needed, and for the student to take responsibility for their actions and to receive some level of consequence. The consequence may differ depending on the situation, circumstances, and whether the behavior has occurred before by the student. Parent notification will be made as needed. If warranted, a serious infraction may be reflected on their official school transcript.

Levels of Consequences

The school's philosophy of discipline is to teach students about responsibility through loving discipline. Violations of school rules will result in appropriate sanctions and consequences in the sole and absolute discretion of the school, including, but not necessarily limited to the following, which are not required to be administered in any progressive order:

Warning: Issued by the Office of Student Life and entered in the student's conduct record (AXIS).

Level 1. School Lunch Detention (30 minutes) — Students who have detention are required to be on campus at the time specified. The assignment will be determined by the Office of Student Life. If a student is late to or misses an assigned detention, s/he will have to serve a Level 2 Detention.

Level 2. School Lunch Detention (45 minutes) – If for any reason the student misses a detention, they will be assigned a Level 3 detention and not be allowed to participate in their extracurricular activities (sports, performing arts, etc.).

Level 3. School Lunch or After School Detention (60 minutes) and No Extracurricular Participation — The school will assign students to a lunch or after school detention when a student's behavior deems it necessary. If a student misses an assigned detention, s/he will serve an In-School Detention the next day. If a student continues to miss a Level 3 detention (even with a parent phone call), s/he will be suspended from school.

> Loss of Privileges — Students who demonstrate a lack of concern for the expectations and rules of the school may have their privileges restricted or removed. Students who have repetitive detentions will lose their privileges (off campus privileges, participation in extracurricular teams or activities, school events, etc.).

Level 4. In-School Detention – Students who receive an In-School detention will serve from 8:30 am – 3:15 pm in a designated room and work on schoolwork or tasks designated by the deans. Students will not be able to use their cell phone, to attend classes, to visit teachers, or to socialize with students during this time. The absence will be considered unexcused but will not receive a grade reduction of any assessment or assignment for that day.

Level 5. Suspension — Students who are suspended may not attend class or school events. The ultimate decision for suspending a student rest with the deans of student life, vice principal, the principal, or the head of school. Suspension may be reported to colleges.

> Assessments and Assignments – Students who are suspended may not earn full credit for assessments since suspensions are considered unexcused absences. The administration has sole discretion to determine this.

> Behavior Contract— Students whose behavior demonstrates a serious or recurring disregard for the spirit of the rules and expectations of the OCS community will be placed on a behavioral contract. Students who commit a subsequent major rules violation while on behavioral contract are likely to be dismissed from school.

Level 6. Dismissal from School — Any student may be dismissed from the school for any violation of school policy, for seriously unacceptable behavior, or when a student's conduct is deemed detrimental to the school's reputation and/or good name. The final and binding determination in the matter of separation from the school lies with the head of school, which determination shall be made in his/her sole and absolute discretion. A student's parents shall have no right to appeal a potential or completed dismissal. The exercise of the head of school's discretion (and the method and procedure by which s/he so exercises discretion) in one circumstance shall not bind or be determinative or instructive with respect to the exercise of the head of school's discretion (and the method and procedure by which s/he so exercises discretion) in another circumstance (whether similar or dissimilar). A student who has been dismissed or who has withdrawn for disciplinary reasons may not return to campus unless he or she has been granted permission by the head of school. See the enrollment contract for tuition refund policies that might be applicable.

College Admission Notification — Oaks Christian School reserves the right to note disciplinary actions on a student's official transcripts, when in the judgment of the school, warrant such notation. Examples include but are not limited to cheating, plagiarism, lying, theft, suspension, etc.

Outside Organizations Notification –The school reserves the right to report suspensions and/or other disciplinary action and attendance records to other organizations (e.g., military, government agencies, auto insurance, employers, NFL, etc.) that inquire about a student's conduct record.

Oaks Christian School, as determined by the administration, reserves the right and authority to govern and rule regarding all other matters not listed here regarding improper behavior by students and discipline while representing the school. Oaks Christian School also reserves the right and authority to govern and rule regarding any matter concerning a student who is involved in illegal activities, whether on campus or off. Such students may be considered for expulsion.

School Discipline: Zero-Tolerance and Restorative Policy

Oaks Christian School has established a zero-tolerance policy for the possession of or use of firearms/weapons and sales or distribution of illegal drugs. Oaks Christian School's Zero-tolerance Policy is as follows:

Possession or Use of Firearms/Weapons

> It is illegal and forbidden to use, sell, or possess firearms/weapons/ammunition (including toy guns or toy weapons).

Possession with the intent to sell or the distribution of forbidden items: illegal drugs and/or prescription drugs

> It is illegal to sell or distribute of these items on campus: illegal drugs, substances representing illegal drugs, prescription drugs or believed to be illegal or dangerous substances, or any substance that can be harmful to the body if ingested into the body.
>
> Law enforcement officials shall be notified where it is deemed necessary.
>
> The Zero-tolerance Policy regarding the possession or use of firearms/weapons, or the sale and distribution of illegal drugs, performance enhancing drugs shall result in school discipline up to automatic dismissal from the school.
>
> Due to the changes in drug use, tobacco products, vaping devices and other paraphernalia, parents/students should expect that some of the policies and procedures will be amended. The school retains the right to change policies, as necessary.

Possession or Use of Illegal Drugs, Alcohol and Performance Enhancing Drugs

Illegal Drugs and Performance Enhancing Drugs — The school reserves the right to drug test students at the school's sole discretion prior to parental permission or presence.

> Drug Dog and Right to Search and Seize – The school reserves the right to search and seize any students' personal property (cars, bags, backpack, wallet, shoes, clothing, car, student lockers) or anything else the administration determines as suspicious. The school reserves the right to utilize the services of IMPACT Canine Solutions for the detection of illegal substances (drugs, alcohol, tobacco, and paraphernalia).

> The drug dog can detect the presence of drugs (illegal, prescription, etc.), alcohol, firearms, and ammunition.

> The school reserves the right to perform random searches without notice. In the case that the drug dog detects anything suspicious, an administrator will perform a search and if necessary, contact law enforcement.

Drug and Alcohol Abuse at Non-School Activities — If an agent of the school becomes aware of alcohol and/or drug use involving our students, we will share this information with the parents and the appropriate authorities and, at the discretion of the head of school, take action.

Controlled Substance Abuse Policy – The following constitutes a violation of the school's policy on controlled substances when they occur on the school campus, in the area surrounding the school campus, at any school-sponsored/related function, or at any other private/public school or school sponsored-/related function:

> Possessing (on the student's person, locker, book bag, vehicle, and/or any object assigned to, owned by, or controlled by them).

> Being, in the opinion of the supervising school official, under the influence of alcohol and/or any dangerous or illegal drug.

> Selling, transferring, or serving as an accessory to the sale or transfer of alcohol and/or any dangerous or illegal drug.

> Possessing drug or alcohol paraphernalia.

The school has the right to administer "breathalyzer" tests and drug tests in cases where there is reasonable suspicion that a student is under the influence of alcohol during school or at any extracurricular activity on or off campus.

The primary responsibility of knowing and controlling the contents of any personal items, lockers, and/or vehicle brought to school or to a school sponsored/related function rests with the student and the student's parents/guardians. Students in violation of the controlled substance abuse policy will be suspended from school or dismissed from OCS. In instances where there may be a violation of the law, students may be turned over to the police. The school does not recognize any form of "medically approved marijuana," including parent approved student use, as justification for drug use or marijuana possession by a student.

Four Step Policy

It is the desire of Oaks Christian School to provide a Christian education to all our students in a drug and alcohol-free environment. We also realize that at times some of our students will make decisions that are not consistent with our desires and policies. Based on our desire to help students who have made wrong choices, we have a Four Step Policy to be utilized by students, if needed. The Four Step Policy may also be appropriate for other discipline issues when a student comes to a teacher or administrator, admits the infraction, and expresses a desire for help in correcting the problem. In the case of the use of alcohol, students are encouraged to come forward on another student's behalf who is unable to do so at that moment if the student is in danger of bringing harm to themselves or to others. In this case the student who has violated a policy may still come forward under the Four Step Policy. To allow our students to be proactive in correcting problems or involvement with drugs or alcohol, we have adopted the following Four Step Policy:

A student may contact a teacher on campus with whom s/he is close and confide in that teacher the problem that s/he is planning to correct.

The student must then inform his/her parents of the problem. (Note: The student is welcome to have the teacher present.)

The teacher will inform the head of school, the principal, the vice principal, and deans of student life of the problem. This is not for the purpose of discipline, but so that they are informed in case a problem were to occur on campus.

Finally, the student must agree to submit to a restorative plan agreed upon by the school, student, and the parents.

Student Expectations Summary

The OCS community is founded on principles of honor, honesty, and mutual trust. The rules that the school has established are essential to the maintenance and continued development of the community spirit. Every student is responsible for obeying these rules. The benefits, for the individual and for the school, of rules and a system of discipline working in concert with each other are two-fold:

For the benefit of the individual:

> To prevent the student from repeating the offense
>
> To help students learn from their mistakes
>
> To teach the value of respect and the rights of others

For the benefit of the institution:

> To deter others
>
> To preserve the standards of the institution
>
> To make it clear to everyone that certain behaviors are not tolerated

Restorative Justice Approach to Student Discipline

Oaks Christian School takes a “restorative justice” approach to student discipline. Understanding that we are all in process, the objectives of our disciplinary procedures and outcomes include:

> resolution
>
> community building
>
> education
>
> character formation
>
> safety

Our approach seeks to take steps to repair harm, involve all stakeholders, change behavior, and transform hearts and minds.

Violations of OCS policies in personal conduct may result in the imposition of one or more of the sanctions listed below. Sanctions that may be imposed are not limited to those listed. In certain limited situations, OCS

officials may impose a sanction but suspend or postpone its actual implementation. Failure to comply with the sanction(s) imposed may result in further disciplinary action. Sanctions affecting the conduct of students are based on general principles of fair treatment. While attempting to be consistent in its disciplinary decisions, Oaks Christian School also seeks to be fair and sensitive to the facts and circumstances of each individual case.

> Warning: Oral or written notice to the student that the student is violating or has violated the code of conduct and that continuation or repetition of misconduct may result in a more severe sanction.

> Loss of Privileges: Such loss may include, but is not limited to, financial aid, eligibility to represent the school officially on athletic teams or performing groups, participation in student life activities, off-campus privileges, etc.

> Restitution: Payment of charges for violations that lead to property damage.

> Detention: Students who have detention are required to be on campus at the time specified. Students may be assigned to complete a detention packet or perform an act of service. The assignment will be determined by the Office of Student Life. If a student is late to or misses an assigned detention, they will be assigned an additional detention or a Level 2 detention.

> Educational Sanctions: Mandatory reading/writing assignment, drug or alcohol assessment/treatment, seminar attendance, or other discretionary sanctions as deemed appropriate.

> Interim Suspension: A short-term suspension (usually 1-3 days) used to investigate further into the situation at hand, to de-escalate a situation, for safety purposes, or to serve as an appropriate consequence. The student may not attend class or school events (unless otherwise stated by administration).

> Deferred Suspension: The student deserves a suspension, but because of their honest contrition and/or proactive action their suspension is deferred and not enacted unless a further offense is committed.

> Probation: Students whose behavior demonstrates a serious or recurring disregard for the spirit of the rules and expectations of the OCS community will be placed on probation. Students who commit a subsequent major rules violation while on probation are likely to be dismissed from the school. Probation carries with it an assumed loss of privileges and the student is in jeopardy of losing financial aid in the subsequent year.

> Suspension: Temporary separation of the student from Oaks Christian School for a definite period of time, after which the student is eligible to return to classes. The student may not attend class or school events (unless otherwise stated by administration). A suspension may be for up to the remainder of a school year, in which case various educational options will be considered. A suspension assumes a reinstatement of the student in the future.

> Expulsion: When a student is dismissed from Oaks Christian School, it is a permanent separation of the student from the school. Any student may be dismissed from the school for any violation of school policy, for seriously unacceptable behavior, or when a student's conduct is deemed detrimental to the school's reputation and/or good name. The final and binding determination in the matter of separation from the school lies with the head of school, which determination shall be made in his/her sole and absolute discretion. A student's parents shall have no right to appeal a potential or completed dismissal. The exercise of the head of school's discretion (and the method and procedure by which s/he so exercises discretion) in one circumstance shall not bind or be determinative or instructive with respect to the

exercise of the head of school's discretion (and the method and procedure by which s/he so exercises discretion) in another circumstance (whether similar or dissimilar). A student who has been dismissed or who has withdrawn for disciplinary reasons may not return to campus unless he or she has been granted permission by the head of school. See the enrollment contract for tuition refund policies.

Parent Expectations

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Overview — A unique aspect of Oaks Christian School is that the family, not just the student, becomes a part of the school community. Oaks Christian School assists parents in their God-given responsibility of educating their children. Any questions or concerns regarding the role of parents at the school should be directed to the Office of the Head of School.

PARENT EXPECTATION POLICY

Parenting is a privilege, an honor, and a blessing, and at times, it can also prove extremely challenging. This can especially be true during adolescence. Some of these challenges include pertinent family conversations regarding parties, alcohol, and drugs. With these challenges in mind, Oaks Christian School seeks to support our families through a drug and alcohol awareness program and through parent education programs that emphasize the accumulated wisdom of experts in the fields of parenting and adolescence, for example, to:

> Stay involved in their children's lives as much as possible and communicate their values to their children, even when they appear uninterested and unaffected.
>
> Verify the whereabouts of their children and network with other parents to stay mutually informed of their children's activities.
>
> Maintain firm and reasonable curfews; and
>
> Make all reasonable efforts to prevent participation of their children in unsupervised parties.

While it is the responsibility of families to have these conversations and create these boundaries, the school exercises disciplinary authority when students use, possess, sell, distribute, or are under the influence of illicit drugs, alcohol, or other intoxicants at school, during a school-sponsored event (i.e. dances, activities, field trips, or athletic contests), are travelling to or are returning from a school-sponsored event, or are in any way representing the school.

As a community, we share a mutual goal of keeping our children safe. With this in mind, when there is alcohol or drugs present at an OCS family hosted party that precedes or follows an Oaks Christian School sponsored activity, this runs contrary to our mutual goal. Therefore, Oaks Christian School reserves the right to dismiss or expel a student/family that hosts such a party where alcohol or drugs are served, tolerated, and/or ignored. In the same manner, if any illegal activity occurs during such a party that is deemed detrimental to the OCS community, this may result in the school taking disciplinary action, including, without limitation, dismissal or expulsion of the student or students from the school.

COOPERATION WITH THE SCHOOL

Overview — As stated in the contract of enrollment, Oaks Christian School believes that a positive and constructive working relationship between the school and a student's parents/guardian is essential to the accomplishment of the school's educational mission.

Right to Terminate Contract — Oaks Christian School accordingly reserves the right to terminate or not renew a student's enrollment contract if the school concludes that the actions of a parent or guardian interfere with such a positive and constructive relationship or otherwise interferes with the school's

accomplishment of its educational purposes. See the enrollment contract for tuition refund policies. It is also expected that parents/guardians cooperate with the administration of the school in seeing that the student attends classes regularly, is at the school premises at the beginning of the school day and has transportation from the school premises at the close of the school day. Furthermore, parents/guardians are expected to assist the student to learn and advance in the educational process, solve school-related problems with teachers and other students, and aid the teachers in providing the student with a Christian education.

Child Abuse Reporting Policy — Certain personnel at Oaks Christian School are mandated reporters under the Child Abuse and Neglect Reporting Act (see, Penal Code Sections 11164 et. seq.), which requires them to report to the proper governmental authority of the State of California certain conduct as specified in the Act.

SEL (Social Emotional Learning) Support

To support our students' thriving, OCS offers on-campus support by qualified mental health clinicians. Students can refer themselves and ‘drop-in’ to see the counselor or they can be referred by faculty, staff, parents, and/or friends. Individual on-campus counseling support offered through the school is a short-term, episodic service aimed at providing immediate relief of acute distress, psychoeducation, coping skills, as well as socialization of the student within the school community. All communications between your student and the school counselor will be held in strict confidence unless you or your student provide written permission to release information about the student’s meetings; however, there are a few exceptions to this.

> Counselors (and all mandated reporters) are required to report instances of suspected child or elder abuse.

> Counselors (and all mandated reporters) are required or permitted to break confidentiality when they have determined that your student presents a danger of physical violence to another person or when your student is a risk to him or herself.

> If the counselor (and all mandated reporters) believes that your student truly intends to harm themselves, he/she will make every effort to ensure their safety, including notifying a caregiver/parent and consulting with supervisors or support staff.

It is important to note that the counselors can provide crisis intervention and regular consultation during normal school hours; however, these services cannot take the place of long-term, comprehensive psychological counseling. Furthermore, we maintain a list of excellent community mental health providers and regularly provide referrals for students and families in need.

Note: If your student reports thoughts of harm to self or others or if, with their clinical judgement, our counselors are concerned about the safety of your student, another student, or the student body, regardless of the above consent, the counselor will act in the best interest of the student and the student body which may include brief risk assessment, notifying supervisors and/or the local Mental Health Evaluation Team, and calling a parent/caregiver. In some cases, the counselor may determine that per school policy an assessment by an outside mental health provider will be required before a student is permitted to return to school.

Campus Security and Safety

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General Procedure
Disaster Drills
Visitors
Food Deliveries
Rideshare Services and Off-Campus Privileges
Lanyard Policy
Consequences (Per Year):

General Procedure

The administration values the safety and well-being of each member of the Oaks Christian School community. The school has partnered with Allied Universal Security in order to provide a school environment that is free from external distractions or issues.

Disaster Drills

Oaks Christian School's disaster drill procedure is as follows:

> Fire drills are held periodically during the school year as mandated by the State of California. Instructions and directions for leaving each room and each building will be given during orientation at the beginning of each school year.

> Directions will also be posted in each room. Students are to recognize the seriousness of such a drill and refrain from improper behavior. Students will report to their teacher (if during a class) for "head count" purposes.

> Earthquake drills may also be held during the school year following guidelines suggested by the State of California. Should there be a major earthquake; students are safer at school than if they tried to get home. Therefore, students will be required to remain at school where they will follow the safety guidelines they have practiced.

> Other drills, such as lock down and evacuation drills may also be held, according to the direction of the administration. The location of the evacuation center in the event of a critical incident during school hours will be at Calvary Community Church 'A' gate parking lot.

Visitors

Oaks Christian School is a closed campus; therefore, any visitor must be approved. All visitors and parents, upon entering campus, should check in ONLY at the front reception desk. Visitors must bring their driver's license to check in. Visitors will receive identification to wear while on campus. The school reserves the right to deny access to the campus to any parent, family member, or visitor.

Food Deliveries

In order to best ensure the safety of our school community, Oaks Christian School does NOT allow delivery drivers to deliver any items to our students on campus during the school day. As parents are a part of our school community, parents may personally deliver items to their student at Front Reception.

Rideshare Services and Off-Campus Privileges

Students are not permitted to use rideshare services, taxis, or similar transportation providers to leave campus during the school day. Once a student arrives on campus, they must remain on campus until dismissal unless signed out by a parent/guardian or an authorized emergency contact. The School will not release students to rideshare drivers or other third-party transportation providers on campus. Any student who leaves campus without authorization is considered off campus without permission and will be subject to disciplinary action.

Lanyard Policy

As a safety precaution, all high school students must wear their lanyard and school identification around their neck while on campus, including open periods. Lanyards must always be worn around the neck and visible (not under jackets or polos). Students found without their school ID's will be directed to the Office of Student Life for disciplinary action (see below). If a student comes to school without their lanyard, they will be sent to the Office of Student Life for a temporary badge and disciplinary action. Students will be provided with an ID card and lanyard at the beginning of the year. Students are only allowed to wear school approved/provided lanyards. The replacement fee is $10.00, $5.00 fee to replace student identification cards and a $5.00 fee to replace lanyards, cash only.

As the campus continues to grow and hosts numerous guests, events, and special programs throughout the year, visible identification provides an additional layer of security without
significantly impacting the student experience. A lanyard system allows staff to quickly identify individuals who may not belong on campus, supports faster and more accurate responses during emergencies, and reduces the need for staff to repeatedly stop students to verify their identity. The purpose of visible identification is to promote a safe, secure, and welcoming learning environment where students can flourish.

Consequences (Per Year):

The entire Oaks Christian School community, including faculty, staff, parents, and students, is responsible for making sure that students follow the safety and security guidelines set by the school. Students who do not follow the school guidelines will be sent to the Office of Student Life and will be required to have a lanyard before returning to class. Repeated violations of the uniform will result in consequences (see below). Each offense will be recorded in AXIS under the student's conduct section.

> 1st Offense – Warning is issued. A temporary badge sticker is given to the students and parents are notified. Students will need to return this badge at the end of the day. If student has lost badge and lanyard, they will need to pay the replacement fee of $10. Parent(s) will receive an automated message.

2nd Offense – A temporary badge sticker is given to the students and parents are communicated with. Students will need to return this badge at the end of the day. If student has lost badge and lanyard, they will need to pay the replacement fee of $10. A communication will be sent to the parent.

3rd Offense – Parent(s) will be contacted by one of the Deans of Student Life. A temporary badge sticker is given to the students. Students will need to return this badge at the end of the day. If student has lost badge and lanyard, they will need to pay the replacement fee of $10.

4th Offense – Student calls parents to either bring their lanyard or buy a new one. Students will not be allowed to return to class without their lanyard and ID. Parent(s) and student will meet with members of the school administration regarding the school uniform infraction, and the student will be placed on a behavior contract.

5th Offense – Student may receive a suspension for non-compliance of safety and security expectations.

6th Offense – Student will be placed on an enrollment hold. Parent(s) and student may be required to meet with the Senior Administration Team.

Facility Use Issues

Original handbook page

Transportation
Student Parking/Automobiles
Bikes, Skateboards, etc.
Hoverboards
Distribution and posting of information
Lockers
Lost and found
Masry Campus Store
Work Permits
Café

Transportation

Parents and students are to follow the policies and procedures regarding transportation to and from school, either by private transportation or by transportation arranged by the school. Students who travel on a school bus or other means of transportation during a school activity are to follow the rules that they are given at that time.

Student Parking/Automobiles

Students who drive to school are to follow the proper traffic flow and procedures. Students are to park in the areas designated for student parking. Students who are interested in parking on campus need to obtain approval by filling out the proper paperwork from the Office of Student Life and receiving a parking pass. This pass shall be always visible while the vehicle is parked on campus. Students are not allowed in the student parking area during school hours, except when they are arriving or leaving school, unless granted written permission from the Office of Student Life. Students are to use their student lockers for those items they will need during the school day. Students who do not park in the designated student parking area, who do not follow the proper traffic flow, who do not have permission to be in the student parking area or who do not drive in a safe and responsible manner may have their parking privileges suspended or revoked. Any student parking a vehicle on campus, or on the street outside of campus, agrees that school personnel have the right to search the vehicle at any time during school hours or during any school activity and student agrees to fully cooperate in providing access to the vehicle upon request by school personnel. Failure of a student to cooperate upon request shall subject the student to disciplinary action, at the sole discretion of the school, including, but not limited to dismissal.

Bikes, Skateboards, etc.

Students who ride a bike to school must secure their bike to the bike rack. Skateboarding or rollerblading on school property is not allowed at any time. Students who bring skateboards, roller blades and/or other such items to school are to store them with the Office of Student Life.

Hoverboards

Students must abide by the state and local laws regarding hoverboards (Assembly Bill 604). Hoverboards are not allowed to be brought, used, or stored on campus due to safety reasons. Hoverboards will be confiscated and released to parents only.

Distribution and posting of information

Persons interested in distributing or posting any information (school and non-school related) on school property must obtain prior approval in writing from the Office of the Head of School or the Office of Student Life. Materials are to be posted in designated spaces (as approved by the Office of Student Life) and not on windows or doors.

Lockers

Students will be issued lockers at the beginning of their freshman year by the attendance office and expected to abide by the following rules:

> In the interest of safety and to ensure compliance with school policies prohibiting the presence of drugs, alcohol, weapons, and contraband, Oaks Christian School reserves the right to inspect lockers and their contents without prior notice or cause.

> The lockers should be kept neat and treated properly. Lockers may be decorated on the inside if done appropriately, but the school reserves the right to require students to remove decorations that are inappropriate. Lockers may not be decorated on the outside except when done for birthdays or other special occasions. These decorations must be ones that can be easily removed by the student at the end of the day. Balloons, crepe paper, and streamers are acceptable, but no glitter, confetti, stickers, or paint allowed.

> Students may access their lockers during any unscheduled period or with teacher permission.

> Students are encouraged to keep valuables locked in their lockers or in their possession at all times.

> Students are not to share their locker or the combination to their locker with anyone.

Lost and found

All articles left on campus, except athletic articles, which will be placed in the lost and found boxes in the locker rooms, will be placed in the lost and found located on the racks on the second floor. Please mark all articles belonging to you with your name and check for any lost item as soon as it is missing. On the last Friday of every month, we will collect all the lost and found items. Labeled items will be made available for retrieval for one extra week. After that time, the name will be removed, and the item will be placed in Malachi’s closet or donated to the Rescue Mission.

Masry Campus Store

Administrated by the Business Office, the Masry Campus Store is open to students during designated hours. Like a college store, students can buy general school supplies, textbooks for classes, and school Spirit Wear.

Work Permits

The registrar's office distributes all work permits to students. Students must maintain a 2.0 unweighted GPA to be granted a work permit during the school year.

Café

Students may use the Collins Café during any unscheduled period, but are not allowed to bring food or drink, except water, into the main building. Students are required to always carry their IDs.